

THE GENERATIONS, A TO Z

by E. Alan Meece

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People who are born and grow up in roughly the same period of history share many characteristics. Their attitudes are formed by common experiences. These are "the generations," and we can paint a miniature portrait of each of them by using the outer planets as "brushes." The traits of each group are revealed by the signs which the three outer planets are in when they are born, and the mutual aspects they make in their birth charts.

The youth of the 1990s are famous as "Generation X." So counting backward from them, we can give each generation a letter in the same series. But since a "generation" like Generation X is supposed to last about 20 years, and the positions of the outer planets usually change faster than that, there are also sub-groups within each generation which I have called, for example, Generation X-a, Generation X-b and so on. The sequence of modern generations starts with Generation T in 1885; the last Generation A would have lived about 400 years earlier. Generation T was very similar to Generation X; in fact, it was the previous "lost generation."

Before Generation T, however, there was an inventive, idealistic generation that shaped modern culture. The last of this group, called "the modernists," were born from 1878-84 and had Uranus in Virgo in trine to Neptune in Taurus, with Pluto in Taurus. We shall call them Generation S-c, although they could also be called the first of Generation T. Most of the modern artists and scientists of the early 20th Century, and many of its most visionary political leaders, came from this creative group. They were idealistic, yet practical. Examples: Mustapha Kemal (Ataturk), John Barrymore, Georges Bracque, Pierre Teilhard de Chardin, Albert Einstein, W.C. Fields, James Joyce, Henri Matisse, Benito Mussolini, Pablo Picasso, Sam Rayburn, Franklin Roosevelt, Oswald Spengler, Joseph Stalin, Igor Stravinsky, Leon Trotsky, Harry Truman.

"Seekers and founders," 1885-1897 (Generation T-a) (Neptune conjunct Pluto in Gemini; Uranus in Libra and Scorpio) These courageous people provided most of those who laid the political and cultural foundations of today's world, often following the course begun by the previous, more inventive generation S. Very sensitive, they loved to explore life's mysteries. But they had to be sharp, ruthless and adaptable in a collapsing world. Many of them died in the Great War; others experienced the upheaval of the 20th Century to its fullest. Examples: Jack Benny, Neils Bohr, Pearl Buck, Chiang Kai Shek, Charles De Gaulle, Will Durant, Jimmy Durante, T.S. Eliot, Dwight D. Eisenhower, William Faulkner, F. Scott Fitzgerald, Francisco Franco, David Ben Gurion, Martin Heidegger, Adolf Hitler, Ho Chi Minh, Aldous Huxley, Nikita Khrushchev, Sinclair Lewis, Huey Long, Mao Tse Tung, Groucho Marx, Jawaharlal Nehru, Eugene O'Neill, Juan Peron, Dane Rudhyar, Josip Broz (Tito), J.R.R. Tolkien, Arnold Toynbee, Grant Wood.

"The flaming wits," 1898-1904 (Generation T-b) (Uranus in Sagittarius opposite Pluto in Gemini; Neptune in Gemini and Cancer) Many revolutionaries come from this group, along with many free-wheeling spirits. They were the "flaming youth" of the roaring 20s. Quite irrepressible, they made great actors and writers. Examples: Louis Armstrong, Humphrey Bogart, Chou En Lai, Gary Cooper, Bing Crosby, Thomas Dewey, Marlene Dietrich, Walt Disney, Enrico Fermi, Clark Gable, Cary Grant, Ernest Hemingway, Heinrich Himmler, Alfred Hitchcock, Bob Hope, Ayatollah Khomeini, Andre Malroux, Margaret Mead, Wayne Morse, Aristotle Onassis, George Orwell, Linus Pauling, Benjamin Spock, John Steinbeck, Adlai Stevenson, Strom Thurmond, Spencer Tracy.

"The organization men (and women)," 1904-1913 (Generation U-a) (Uranus in Capricorn and early Aquarius, opposite Neptune in Cancer; Pluto in Gemini) Bold and adventurous, many of these people were also emotionally unstable, secretive, extreme or fanatic. Though often dissatisfied with their lot in life, most remained conservative and traditional; experts at rising within the ranks and interested in business. Those born 1912-13 border the next group. Examples: Spiro Agnew, Leonid Brezhnev, Warren Burger, Albert Camus (1913), William Casey (1913), Norman Cousins (1912), Richard J. Daley, Henry Fonda, Gerald Ford (1913), John K. Galbraith, Barry Goldwater, Dag Hammarskjold, Rex Harrison, Katharine Hepburn, L. Ron Hubbard, Howard Hughes, Hubert Humphrey, Lyndon Johnson, Marshall McLuhan, Joseph McCarthy, Richard Nixon (1913), Lawrence Olivier, Tip O'Neill (1912), Ronald Reagan, Nelson Rockefeller, Dean Rusk, Jean Paul Sartre, Robert Young.

"The techno-altruists," 1914-1919 (Generation U-b) (Uranus in Aquarius, Neptune in Leo, Pluto in Cancer) This group is similar to the previous one, but is more intellectual and more dedicated to social ideals. They were very charismatic leaders or personalities and provided most of the corporate technocrats. They were the knights of Kennedy's "Camelot." Examples: Leonard Bernstein, Walter Cronkite, Jackie Gleason, Paul Harvey, John F. Kennedy, Eugene McCarthy, Robert McNamara, Howard Metzenbaum, Edmund Muskie, Gregory Peck, William Proxmire, Anthony Quinn, Anwar Sadat, Arthur Schlesinger, Pete Seeger, Sargent Shriver, George Wallace (1919), Mike Wallace, Alan Watts, Caspar Weinberger, Orson Welles.

"The warm souls," 1920-1929 (Generation V-a) (Uranus in Pisces, Neptune in Leo, Pluto in Cancer) This group is inwardly secure and confident. They are conventional, warm-hearted and sensitive and are subject to strange mystical experiences. Though humanitarian, they have made generally poor political leaders. But many excellent actors and poets come from this group. Examples: Marlon Brando, David Brinkley, Richard Burton, George Bush, Johnny Carson, Jimmy Carter, Fidel Castro, Judy Garland, Allen Ginsberg, John Glenn, Alexander Haig, Joseph Heller, Lee Iaccoca, John Paul II, Robert Kennedy, Henry Kissinger, Timothy Leary, Jack Lemmon, Norman Mailer, George McGovern, Don Rickles, Rod Serling, Sen. Paul Simon, Gore Vidal, Kurt Vonnegut.

The last part of this group (1927-29) has Uranus in Aries; thus is more rebellious, activist and individualist: Cesar Chavez, James Garner, Che Guevara, Martin Luther King, Patrick McGovern, Harvey Milk, Walter Mondale.

"The rebels without a cause," 1930-35 (Generation V-b) (Uranus in Aries square Pluto in Cancer; Neptune in Virgo) This is an unpredictable, sometimes wild and explosive group that provided the leaders of the "Beat Generation." They make innovative, caring leaders, but often lack specific goals and are insecure or unsure of their direction. It is the first generation born after Pluto's discovery, so it and succeeding groups are sometimes less wedded to ancient traditions. Examples: Marshall Applewhite, Mario Cuomo, James Dean, Michael Dukakis, Mikhail Gorbachev, Dick Gregory, Jim Jones, Jack Kemp, Ted Kennedy, Ken Kesey, Paul Krassner, Charles Kuralt, Jerry Lee Lewis, Shirley MacLaine, Charles Manson, Bill Moyers, Ralph Nader, Leonard Nimoy, Peter O'Toole, Ross Perot, Elvis Presley, Dan Rather, Carl Sagan, Elizabeth Taylor, Robert Anton Wilson, Boris Yeltsin, Andrew Young.

"The silent generation," 1935-1939 (Generation V-c) (Uranus in Taurus, Neptune in Virgo, Pluto in Cancer) With all three planets in passive signs, they tended to be shy, quiet, conforming, moody, dreamy, sympathetic and introspective. But sometimes they have become outspoken due to their desire to help others; and like the previous group can be quite unpredictable. Examples: Woody Allen, Bruce Babbitt, Warren Beatty, Jerry Brown, Pat Buchanan, Judy Collins, Jane Fonda, David Frost, Gary Hart, Dustin Hoffman, Barbara Jordan, Jack Nicholson, Robert Redford, Sam Nunn, Ted Turner.

"The war babies," 1939-1946 (Generation W-a) (Uranus in Taurus/Gemini, trine Neptune in Virgo/Libra; Pluto in Leo) This group provided the leaders of the "60s generation." They are outspoken, visionary and unconventional, but they burned up much of their energy in their youth (Gemini). Impulsive, confident, spontaneous and restless, they are rebels with a cause and can become great leaders. But perhaps they have been too fickle or adaptable to remain true to the great ideals of their youth. This group and the next are very musically talented. Examples: Muhammed Ali, Joan Baez, The Beatles, Joseph Biden, Chevy Chase, Robert DeNiro, John Denver, Bob Dylan, Richard Gephardt, Newt Gingrich, Tom Hayden, Jimi Hendrix, Jesse Jackson, Mick Jagger, Janis Joplin, Ted Koppel, Oliver North, Pat Schroeder, Tom Selleck, Pete Townshend, Paul Tsongas.

"The baby boomers," 1946-1956 (Generation W-b) (Uranus in late Gemini and Cancer, square Neptune in Libra; Pluto in Leo) This populous group is famous for its idealism and provided the "shock troops" for the sixties rebellions. These "flower children" are outgoing, warm, adventurous, confident, outspoken and exhibitionist; but less original than the war babies. Born to prosperous but uncertain times, they were called "spoiled" and "impatient;" yet although they dropped out as "hippies," they also became the first "yuppies" (young urban professionals). They insist on their creative autonomy (Leo), but also long for union with others (Libra); so some of them are emotionally insecure or inconsistent. Examples: Cher, Bill Clinton (1946), Kevin Costner, Billy Crystal, Al Gore Jr., Jay Leno, David Letterman, Joe Montana, Jane Pauley, Arnold Schwarzenegger, Jerry Seinfeld, Bruce Springsteen, Meryl Streep, John Travolta, Robin Williams, Oprah Winfrey.

"The baby boomers, part two," 1957-62 (Generation W-c) (Uranus in Leo, Neptune in Scorpio, Pluto in Virgo) This group was too young for the sixties and so are more conventional in their approach to life. They are talented investigators or analysts and provide many of the "yuppie"

computer professionals. Most in this group are self-contained, shrewd, secretive, careful, tenacious, calculating and capable. They are more thoughtful, hesitant, reflective and unsure than the elder boomers, but often no less outgoing and exhibitionist (since Uranus is in Leo). In fact, many in this group have already made quite an impression in the show business world. Examples: Scott Baio, Matthew Broderick, Katie Couric, Tom Cruise, Michael J. Fox, Woody Harrelson, Michael Jackson, Madonna, Demi Moore, Eddie Murphy, Donny Osmond, Sean Penn, Prince, Tim Robbins.

"The techno-punks," 1963-1969 (Generation X-a) (Uranus conjunct Pluto in Virgo; Neptune in Scorpio) It was said that the "punks" were the hippies of the eighties. This group is free-wheeling, impulsive, clever and resourceful, but more hard-nosed and cynical than the baby boomers were. They grew up in a declining society with little moral direction, and so have been called "the new lost generation" (the old was the group of "seekers" born during the Neptune-Pluto conjunction). They were labeled "Generation X" because they were so unsure of their identity or purpose. Despite having to grow up as "brash, pragmatic, suspicious, skeptical, selfish, sharp-eyed survivalists," this group has enormous creative potential once they find something to believe in. The first children of the computer age, they will undergo many personal upheavals and changes. Great scientists, artists and revolutionary political leaders could emerge from this group. Examples: Lisa Bonet, Kurt Cobain, Gary Coleman, Rob Lowe, Marla Matlin, Sinad O'Connor, Luke Perry, Jason Priestley, Kiefer Sutherland.

"The mellow ones," 1970-1974 (Generation X-b) (Uranus in Libra, Neptune in Sagittarius, Pluto in Virgo/Libra) This is mostly a friendly, easy-going, confused, flabby, indolent group of "slackers," but it has great potential in music and diplomacy. Not so fanatical and less cynical than their elder brothers and sisters, they are often wise, generous and mature. This group needs to get off its duff and make up for its poor educational background. Once it does, some very talented artists, writers, philosophers and teachers may come from this sub-generation. Examples: Christina Applegate, Kirk Cameron, Neil Patrick Harris.

"The explorers," 1975-1981 (Generation X-c) (Uranus in Scorpio, Neptune in Sagittarius, Pluto in Libra) This group is more intense, exuberant, and disciplined than the previous one. They are "mellow," but also very cynical. Relationships and sex are important to this generation, like other recent ones. Many children of the seventies and eighties feel the need to fill the cultural void in their lives by exploring the unknown and traveling widely. They see the lurking danger to their future, so the best of them are driven to investigate the roots of our problems. But others may act out their alienation destructively. Examples: Macauley Culkin, Fred Savage.

"Explorers, part two," 1982-84 (Generation X-d) (Uranus and Neptune in Sagittarius, Pluto in Libra) Temperamentally this exuberant group is more like the "mellow ones," but they are also definitely "explorers." They are undisciplined and unfocused, but probably very positive and mature otherwise. This transitional sub-generation will be a great source of visionaries, adventurers, humorists, storytellers, writers and philosophers, but don't look for too many great political leaders.

"The benevolent entrepreneurs," 1984-88 (Generation Y-a) (Uranus in Sagittarius, Neptune in Capricorn, Pluto in Scorpio) This is a more ambitious and well-disciplined group. It will include many far-seeing and important leaders and entrepreneurs. Though most will probably be on the conservative side, many will organize great projects for the public benefit. They feel a great duty to society and Humanity.

"The committed ones," 1988-1995 (Generation Y-b) (Uranus conjunct Neptune in Capricorn, Pluto in Scorpio) This is a group with outstanding potential. It is a very precocious generation, but won't burn itself out in youth. They are steady, persistent, determined, ambitious and passionate. They have great talent in the arts, politics and organization, and they may be the great leaders who lay down lasting foundations for a new age of civilization. On the other hand, some might consider them too cold, calculating, rigid, worldly or obsessed with their own goals.

"The flame throwers," 1996-2003 (Generation Y-c) (Uranus in Aquarius, Neptune in late Capricorn and Aquarius, Pluto in Sagittarius) This will be a very outgoing, irrepressible, exuberant generation, quick to question authority and convention. They will be brilliant intellectuals, inventors, reformers and propagandists.

"The universal free spirits," 2003-2010 (Generation Z-a) (Uranus in Pisces, Neptune in Aquarius, Pluto in Sagittarius/early Capricorn) Their successors will be similar, but more easy-going, sensitive and poetic. They will follow the paths laid down by the previous two generations, but will show greater brilliance in the imaginative arts. As the first of Generation Z, they will teach compassion for Humanity as we all reach the "omega point" of universal human awareness after 2012.

"Lonely rebels," 2011-2018 (Generation Z-b) (Uranus in Aries square Pluto in Capricorn; Neptune in Pisces) This group will be similar to those born in the early 1930s. Like them, they will be confused rebels or lonely seekers in their youth. Growing up in times of crisis, they will insist on breaking free from authorities and blazing their own path, however unsure of where it might lead them. Highly visionary, in later years some of them will be able to adapt and find a powerful leadership position within society.

"Silent searchers," 2018-2025 (Generation Z-c) (Uranus in Taurus, Neptune in Pisces, Pluto in Capricorn) This generation will be very similar to the "silent generation" of the late 1930s. Confused seekers like their elder brothers and sisters, they will quietly keep many of their hopes and dreams to themselves until later in life, when they will effectively act on their desire to help others. But many in this group will be acquisitive and conformist due to their overweening desire for security.

"Green pioneers," 2025-2032 (Generation A-a) Uranus in Gemini trine Pluto in Aquarius; sextile Neptune in Aries. With this generation we start our letter count over again and arrive back at "A" (the last such generation A having lived about 500 years ago). Like the "war babies" of the 1940s, this will be a highly idealistic, inventive, dynamic and creative group determined to change the world. Instead of "dropping out" or protesting against society as their grandparents did, these people will be intensely active and goal-oriented. They will be the young leaders of

the "Green Revolution" at mid-century, intent on transforming the world no matter how disruptive it may be to the peace or the status quo.

GENERATIONS IN AMERICA

[William Strauss and Neil Howe](#) wrote a best seller (explained in the San Jose Mercury News, March 31, 1991) entitled *Generations: The History of America's Future*. They have no knowledge of astrology as far as I know; nevertheless this book has become quite famous in the astrological community. Why? Because the length of the "generational cycle" they describe is 80 to 90 years; the same as the time Uranus takes to travel around the zodiac (84 years). The authors described a repeating pattern of generations whose characteristics largely determined American history; and therefore, the future. We are each children of the times in which we grew up; we carry that signature through our lives and thus influence history in turn. Strauss and Howe (themselves baby boomers) traced a cycle of 4 types of generation (each about 20 years long) which have reappeared five times since 1584: Idealist, Reactive, Civic, and Adaptive (perhaps akin to fire, earth, air and water). Each is built around the periodic "great American worldly crisis" that corresponds with the transit of Uranus in Gemini every 84 years: King William's War (1689-97), the Revolutionary War (1774-81), the Civil War (1861-65), and the Great Depression-- World War II (1941-45). About 25 to 40 years later a "spiritual awakening" comes. American history oscillates between these two poles.

The cycle works something like this: the Idealists grow up indulged in a prosperous but spiritually-impooverished world which has successfully navigated the great crisis, and comes of age propelled by a spiritual awakening. They become elder leaders during the next crisis. The Reactives grow up during a spiritual awakening when institutions are being questioned or destroyed. Their elders desert them to pursue religious or personal growth, so they become alienated risk takers and mature into pragmatic managers. Next, the Civics grow up under Idealist parents who give strong moral guidance. In youth they give themselves dutifully to help in the great crisis, brought on by the mounting neglect of secular problems. Afterward they build powerful institutions, only to be criticized as "too worldly" by the next wave of Idealists. Finally, an Adaptive generation grows up ignored and "suffocated" by the great crisis. Sensitive and sympathetic, they emulate and conform to their elders, but in mid-life pursue personal growth and social concern during the next awakening. Interestingly, Strauss and Howe predict another great American crisis for the 2020s, just as astrologers do. Among groups described above, Generations S (modernists), W (war babies and baby boomers) and A (green pioneers) are Idealists; Generations T (seekers) and X (techno-punks and explorers) are Reactives; Generations U (organization men and techno-altruists) and Y (entrepreneurs, committed ones and flame throwers) are Civics; Generations V (the rebels without a cause and the silent generation) and Z (the free spirits and lonely rebels) are Adaptives.

Various astrologers have tried to link these traits with the sign Uranus occupies when they are born. What they often forget is that this is purely a cycle of American history. The key to this cycle is Uranus' karmic return to Gemini, which signals the "great American crisis" every 84 years. It is also the time when the first idealists are born. However, Howe and Strauss sometimes "stretched forward" the generations to conform with events. The Romantic

Movement, for example, was so powerful that this "spiritual awakening" had the effect of postponing the reactive generation for over 20 years. In fact, Strauss and Howe had to eliminate one entire Civic generation to make room for their extended "Idealist" generation born from 1792 to 1822. If we make the cycle regular, however (with some minor "stretching forward," depending on other aspects), we can say in general that Idealists are born with Uranus in signs near the Summer Solstice (Gemini, Cancer, Leo; which corresponds to the period when the war babies and baby boomers were born: 1942-1962). These signs have the "narcissistic" and "inward-turning" qualities supposed to characterize the Idealists. Civic generations thus have Uranus in the opposite signs of the Winter Solstice (Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius), which are directed outward toward institutional success. The other generations are born with Uranus near the equinox; they "mediate" between the Idealists and Civics.

the tools of astrology are mythical symbols. By grouping many qualities under a common symbol, we understand the hidden connections between them. Astrological symbols allow us to comprehend the mysterious working relationship between all things. As we saw in the last chapter, the three basic cycles of the Earth, together with the three invisible planets, are the most important of these symbols in our quest to understand human destiny. But the other 7 visible planets are also important. Like the outer planets in the transcendental trinity, each visible planet represents fundamental drives and functions within Humanity. Their place in a horoscope shows where their energy is focused and directed in the life of a person or a nation.

THE SEVEN INNER PLANETS AND LIGHTS

The Sun is the source of life for the solar system. It represents the conscious mind, will, ego, vitality, leadership, power and authority. It rules important people, royalty, nobility, the head of state, the government, the father. It signifies expressions of confidence such as sports, the theater, gambling, romance. It stands for our genuine, authentic self; our ability to radiate and shine. It rules the 5th sign Leo, and the 5th House. Its cycle lasts 1 year, equivalent to the Earth's year.

The Moon is the complement of the Sun, reflecting its light onto the Earth and governing its tides and cycles. Seen from our planet the two "lights" are equal in size. The Moon is our subconscious mind, habits, feelings, moods, instincts, reflections, aspirations; it nurtures growth and protects life. It represents fluctuation, the feminine, the mother, the common people and their needs. It represents both the sea and the fertility of the land. It rules the 4th sign Cancer and the 4th house. It orbits the Earth and the zodiac every 28 days, and it completes one cycle between New Moons (one lunation) every 29 and 1/2 days (about 1 month or 1 sign).

Mercury is the fastest planet and one of the smallest; it is also closest to the Sun. Named for the messenger of the gods, Mercury is inventive, restless, curious. It stands for communication, media, thought, mobility, writing and education. It is the symbol of youth, students, workers, merchants and civil servants. It rules the 3rd sign Gemini, the 6th sign Virgo, and the 3rd and 6th Houses. It orbits the Sun every 88 days, over four times a year.

Venus is the brightest and loveliest planet. The Earth's closest neighbor toward the Sun, it represents our impulse to reflect, balance and evaluate. It brings love, peace and harmony; it rules diplomacy, cooperation and strategy. It stands for beauty, nature, the arts, affection, young women, social life, pleasure and happiness; it rules wealth, money and luxury goods. It rules the 2nd sign Taurus, the 7th sign Libra, and the 2nd and 7th Houses. It revolves around the Sun every 225 days.

Mars is the red planet, and the first leading us outward toward the stars. Thus it stands for our desire to venture outward. Mars is energetic, impulsive and active; it stands for enterprise, adventure, enthusiasm, missionary zeal, courage, athletic and mechanical skill, sexual desire. It brings war, violence, quarrels and accidents. It signifies machismo, the armed forces, pioneers, agitators. It rules the 1st sign Aries, the 8th sign Scorpio, and the 1st and 8th Houses. Its period of revolution around the Sun lasts almost 2 years.

Jupiter is the largest planet, yet turns on its axis the fastest. As the first of the huge, gaseous planets outward from the Sun, it represents expanding opportunities and widening horizons. It stands for wisdom, the higher mind, prophecy, the Church, universities, law, ceremonies and rituals. It establishes far-ranging connections between people and ideas. It rules long-distance journeys, foreigners, diplomacy, treaties, publishing. It is the planet of abundance, prosperity, generosity, joviality, fortune, optimism, finance, world commerce; but it tends to excess, over-confidence, self-righteousness, complacency and the resulting errors. It rules the 9th sign Sagittarius, the 12th sign Pisces, and the 9th and 12th houses. It orbits the Sun in just under 12 years.

Saturn is the ringed planet which encloses and encircles what is within its realm. It is the highest authority in the visible world, defining its limits, form and structure. It represents caution, conservatism, realism, pessimism, orthodoxy, old age. It brings depression, poverty, stagnation, restriction, limitation, misfortune. It elicits depth and seriousness of thought, science, ambition, perseverance, desire for fame and status. It represents the State, the Establishment, politics, organization, hierarchy, aristocracy, the executive branch; it institutes repression, imposes order, demands discipline, establishes justice. It signifies miners, land owners, farmers, officials, administrators. Saturn represents the world and all its ways. It rules the 10th sign Capricorn, the 11th sign Aquarius, and the 10th and 11th houses. Its orbit lasts 29 and 1/2 years.

Many astrologers now say that Uranus is a higher octave of Mercury, Neptune of Venus, and Pluto of Mars. Uranus also has a close relationship to Saturn and Neptune is closely related to Jupiter. Note the astrological terms based on planetary influences that have come into our language, such as lunatic, mercurial, martial, jovial, saturnine, etc.

Chiron is a small body that is something between a huge comet and a tiny planet, and is usually found somewhere between the orbits of Saturn and Uranus. Discovered in 1977, it acts as a "key" or bridge between the visible and transcendental realms. It is linked to the mythology of the centaur and the "wounded healer" and to the signs Virgo and Sagittarius. Since the 1990s, other "centaurs" have been found in this area of the solar system.

URANUS, THE MAVERICK (1781)

For historians, this moment represents the beginning of the modern age. Radical, sweeping changes have totally transformed the world since Uranus was first seen in 1781. All the ancient ways have been upset, and the pace of events has accelerated. Powerful new potentials have opened to us. We have taken a gigantic, terrifying and irreversible leap into the future and have begun to expand our consciousness. For astrologers, the discovery of Uranus in 1781 represents the start of this dramatic shift. Each new planet discovered represents further stages in our expansion of consciousness and human potential. For although the transcendental trinity has always influenced human history, until modern times it had only done so on an unconscious level for most people; now their true significance is being fully revealed to all of us.

Revolutionary developments opened this age of expansion in the late 18th Century. At the very time Uranus was discovered, the United States had just won its independence, and the sparks from that upheaval soon lit the fuse of a much larger one in France. The French Revolution of 1789 kindled the light of liberty and the flames of ferment over the whole world. Meanwhile a quieter but even more drastic transformation was reverberating through Britain. The industrial revolution also took off in the 1780s, mobilizing human and technical resources as never before. These two dramatic, explosive events that irreversibly changed our planet happened at the same moment that the astronomer Herschel discovered a new planet in the sky.

But the Uranian wave was felt everywhere, and in many ways. In Germany the Revolution occurred in the realm of philosophy when Immanuel Kant published *The Critique of Pure Reason* in 1781 (exact year of Uranus' discovery), brilliantly demonstrating how knowledge depends on our own categories of thought. It was a declaration of independence for the mind. Simultaneously German and British writers unleashed an ecstasy of self-discovery called "the romantic movement" and asserted the creative freedom of the artist. For the French painter J.L.David, art became a means to arouse the people to revolt ("Oath of the Horatii," 1784). At the same time the infinite dimensions of the universe began to open up. Light was expanded beyond the normal visible spectrum to include ultra-violet and infra-red. And discovery of the laws of electricity in the 1780s and 90s eventually turned our knowledge of the physical world upside down.

It was clear from the start what Uranus would stand for in astrology. Its discovery in 1781 represents the end of the Reign of Chronos (Saturn) in the life of Humanity. It is the critical break from the past into the modern age of "progress." Its role is to free us from all conventional authorities and to drastically reform society along lines of truth and justice. It stands for our new awareness of individual freedom and liberty, and for "declarations of independence." Depending on other factors in force at the time, it can bring quick, beneficial reforms or violent, disruptive, destructive events. It is also associated with science and "enlightenment;" it seeks to base authority on knowledge which we discover for ourselves. The planet of genius, Uranus constantly challenges us to look at things in a new way. It is sudden revelations and awakenings; it is the ruling planet of magicians, alchemists and astrologers. The cosmic lightning bolt among the planets, its effects are always very striking, abrupt and powerfully felt. It signifies charismatic leaders with enormous power; it stands for the modern dictator as much as

the modern liberator. It is the planet of the eccentric and unconventional; anything surprising unusual, radical, outcast and different from the norm. It represents all the inventions of the modern age and the skill to create and use them. It rules capitalism, "progress" and utopian expectations; one of the symbols of the "New Age." It is linked to Aquarius, the 11th sign of the zodiac, and with the 11th House of the horoscope. Uranus represents the inner light; the creator from the invisible realms.

NEPTUNE, THE MYSTIC (1846)

Astronomers soon realized that the new planet didn't behave as they expected (typical of Uranus, after all). Another planet was suspected further out that would explain the strange perturbations in Uranus' orbit, and in 1846 some astronomers found it where LeVerrier and Adams predicted it would be. This new planet would turn out to be even more valuable in understanding human destiny than Uranus is. It was named Neptune after the ancient god of the oceans, and its discovery coincided with the next expansion in modern consciousness.

When Neptune was discovered, the masses of common people were sensing their power and identity as never before. The industrial revolution, until now largely limited to a few entrepreneurs and inventors in England, began to expand across the world. People started clustering together in vast urban conglomerations. Stripped from their roots and cut off from their old communities, people in the new cities began identifying themselves with their nation or social class. The ties that bound the old society together began to decay and disintegrate, as famines and revolutions caused millions to migrate across the globe. Meanwhile society was convulsed with idealistic, utopian movements. Kindness and compassion toward the less fortunate entered human consciousness and history for the first time. Dorothea Dix, Florence Nightengale, Clara Barton and others promoted the new humanitarian ideal. Two years after Neptune's discovery Marx and Engels published the Communist Manifesto, inaugurating a compelling and convulsive new movement toward human equality. Meanwhile communal experiments spread across America, and the Mormons made their epic journey to Utah. A new religion sprang forth in Persia proclaiming the coming unification of Humanity (the Bahai Faith). Interest in spiritualism and metaphysics mushroomed. Transcendentalist writers extolled non-conformity and the oversoul. Gas lighting spread through the cities, and anesthesia was applied to surgery. Ocean-going steamships made global commerce practical for the first time in history.

Neptune's character reflects these dynamic changes of the 1840s and 50s, and incarnates all the great movements of the 19th Century. If Uranus represented freedom for the individual, Neptune stands for equality and the interests of collective society. It represents utopian social movements whose goal is to redistribute the wealth. Neptune symbolizes compassion, kindness and humanitarian concern; it rules hospitals, asylums, prisons and big bureaucracies. More than any other planet its movements represent the destiny and consciousness of Humanity as a whole, and the "spirit of the times."

If Uranus is the transcendental mind, Neptune is the transcendental heart. It represents consciousness expanding until it encompasses all Humanity and the entire universe. It is the

symbol of everything intangible, mystical, imaginative, delicate and subtle, particularly as expressed through the most sensitive kinds of romantic, impressionist and New Age visionary music and art. It is the urge to escape into a blissful state of ecstasy and reverie. It is life unrestricted by ordinary limits and boundaries; the desire to transcend all barriers and return to paradise and the golden age. But since it is so elusive and hard to pin down, Neptune often leads us into confusion, delusion and deception. Its talents are easily adapted by all who are in the business to deceive. It is the desire to escape from responsibility and to artfully and cleverly avoid facing reality. It frequently leads people and their leaders into involved and muddled affairs; it can signal floods, famines and diseases.

Since Neptune's discovery, distribution of goods and services have increasingly been made on the broadest possible scale. Neptune stands for liquids, the seas, oils, solvents, drugs, alcohol, psychedelic plants, funguses. It represents decay and dissolution, but also grand summation. When fully expressed, Neptune is the beatific vision of universal, divine love and compassion for all beings. It is connected to Pisces, the 12th and final sign of the zodiac, and to the 12th House.

PLUTO, LORD OF THE UNDERWORLD (1930)

One would think that with Neptune we have reached the ultimate; what could be higher than to connect with the infinite and the divine? But there is another planet; the necessary partner, shadow and complement to Neptune. For there is no heaven without hell, and no dissolution, decay and death without the possibility of rebirth and new life. Astronomers soon found that Neptune too was wandering from its predicted path, so they began looking for "planet X." It was found early in 1930 by Clyde Tombaugh. The name Pluto was taken from the initials of Percival Lowell, the man who predicted where the new planet would be found.

When Pluto was discovered, Humanity was entering the deepest crisis in its history. The Great Depression was spreading; all the old values and authorities seemed to be crumbling. Hell on Earth loomed as the Nazis took over Europe. Gangsters and syndicates were becoming rampant, and big governments and corporations were taking control. Meanwhile philosophers and psychologists such as Heidegger, Jung and Reich were probing the human personality seeking sources of inner power, and physics was unveiling a whole new universe where uncertainty reigned supreme. Soon the atomic bomb confronted us with our own power to destroy all life on the planet.

Pluto, named for the Lord of the Underworld, is thus the symbol of death, destruction and total annihilation; of drastic change and complete transmutation. It leads us through the valley of the shadow of death and the dark night of the soul. Where Neptune offers forgiveness, compassion and escape, Pluto confronts us with our responsibilities. Pluto is the probing detective; it plumbs the depths and explores beyond the edges to unleash new sources of power. It is the cosmic plunger seeking to eliminate anything that obstructs the flow of change. Where Uranus is the lightning flash, and Neptune the cosmic sea, Pluto is the atomic fire. With Pluto we make ourselves more vulnerable that we may become more potent, as therapist Stan Dale puts it. Pluto is transcendental courage and guts; it gives us new life by forcing us to face death. It is the caterpillar shedding its skin to reveal the butterfly; the phoenix rising from the ashes. It is the

revelation of deep changes going on inside us. It destroys that we may rebuild; it kills the old self that we may be born anew.

Pluto charts the rise and fall of all civilizations and power structures. It rules groups, syndicates, and all who pool their resources to boost their power; it can release undreamed-of wealth and opportunity. It is connected to all the movements of the 20th Century, such as existentialism, vitalism, totalitarianism, sexual revolutions, the rights of minorities and outcasts. What it touches it eliminates, rejuvenates and reorganizes. Whereas Neptune insidiously dissolves and breaks things down, Pluto seeks to totally destroy and then rebuild them. Along with the Moon it is connected to agriculture and all cycles of death and rebirth through its mythic connection with Persephone; it is sexuality and fertility worship. It represents all the secrets of biology and the mysteries of creation.

Along about 1979, as Pluto's eccentric and elongated orbit took it inside Neptune's orbit, astronomers discovered that Pluto had a partner. They named it Charon; which significantly has only one letter different from Chiron, the comet-asteroid discovered at about the same time to be orbiting between Saturn and Uranus. As our view of Pluto changes it continues to bring forth new movements, such as ecology and feminism. Now interdependence is replacing the older Plutonian ideal of totalitarian power. It has become clear that Pluto-Charon is a dual planet, representing its two-sided nature as death and new life. Apparently Pluto and its partner revolve around each other at the same rate so they are always facing each other. This represents the principle of complementarity, which Neils Bohr recognized at the heart of all things. It is thus not only the polarizing but the synthesizing planet, bringing together the individual and the collective to form the creative. Along with Chiron, it reconciles inner and outer worlds, male and female. As the New Age dawns we will discover Pluto as primarily the planet that periodically brings new life and a renaissance of the human spirit. Pluto is linked to the 8th sign Scorpio and the 8th house, and is also strongly associated with the first sign Aries.

Thus, in the transcendental trinity of planets Uranus is the Lord of Light, Neptune is the Redeemer of Love and Pluto is the Restorer of Life.

In the 21st century, as I suggested might happen (but didn't predict), other small planets have been found beyond Neptune and Pluto in the "Kuiper Belt" and beyond. I have posted some thoughts on these in my [Planetary Dynamics](#) article.

THE SIGNS OF THE ZODIAC

As we mentioned, the Zodiac is the path of the Earth's orbit around the Sun; one of the three basic Earth cycles. The Sun appears to move through the Zodiac as the Earth orbits around the Sun, and the planets follow the same path. So, for example, when Saturn is in the same place where the Sun appears around March 1, Saturn is said to be in Pisces. It thus takes on the meanings of that sign and transmits them to Earth. The functions of Saturn (government, limitation, etc.) are experienced by us in a Piscean way, and the traits of Pisces become more important in world affairs.

Characteristics of the signs:

All twelve signs are 30-degree segments of the Zodiac. They are each associated with the four **elements** discussed by the Greek philosophers: fire, earth, air and water. The elements are not "old superstitions," but equivalent to the "states of matter" known to science today: solid, liquid, gas, and conversion into energy. But they also represent the basic parts of the human soul.

The **Fire** signs are Aries, Leo and Sagittarius. Fire sign natives are active, enthusiastic, creative, inspirational, enterprising, spirited, adventurous, proud, self-assertive, self-confident. They are full of energy and vitality and tend to be leaders. They are passionate, impatient and easily angered. Fire signs are of the masculine gender (active, extroverted, yang) and are linked to the spiritual aspect of the psyche.

The **Earth** signs are Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn. Earth sign natives are practical, reliable, cautious, plodding, pragmatic, careful, and sure-footed. They make all the enterprises of the fire people more useful, secure and long-lasting. Earth represents the wealth and work of the world. Earth signs are of the feminine gender (meaning passive, introvert, yin) and are linked to the body or physical aspect of the psyche.

The **Air** signs are Gemini, Libra and Aquarius. They are intelligent, sociable, quick-witted, inventive, adaptable, diplomatic and versatile. They are well educated, cultured and full of new ideas; they open channels of communication and distribution. They can be fickle, flighty or unpredictable. Air signs are masculine and linked to the mind.

The **Water** signs are Cancer, Scorpio and Pisces. Water sign natives are emotional, sensitive, receptive and imaginative; they rely on their feelings, instincts and intuition. They are sympathetic, humane and nurturing, but can be escapist or manipulative. Water signs dissolve barriers and nourish new growth; they elicit mass group experiences and spiritual aspirations. Water signs are feminine and linked to the emotions.

Qualities. Each sign is also cardinal, fixed or mutable. These are modes of behavior and action rather than basic substances of nature or psyche. This is astrology's version of the trinity: the universal principle that all things unfold in three stages.

Cardinal signs are Aries, Cancer, Libra and Capricorn. They are generating, initiating, enterprising, pioneering, creative, combative, assertive; each in the manner of their element. They have to do with new beginnings, but they don't always finish what they start.

Fixed signs are Taurus, Leo, Scorpio and Aquarius. They are organizing, perpetuating, enduring, single-minded, dictatorial. They are known to be stubborn or dogmatic and are concerned with economics. They can concentrate enormous power.

Mutable signs are Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius and Pisces. They are adaptable, adjustable, restless, curious, democratic. They deal with travel, trade, distribution, and uncertain or chaotic conditions. They are "dual" signs, so they can be inconsistent or deceptive. They seek variety, knowledge, understanding and synthesis.

A table of correspondences is given below. Ada M. Palles proposes that signs also have sub-elements (see *The Mountain Astrologer*, Dec./Jan. 1992), adding further to their meaning (see table on right):

ARIES, the Ram. First sign of the zodiac, March 21-April 20. Cardinal fire sign; ruler, Mars. Motto: "I am." Aries represents the first urge of life to manifest in the world. It is the sheer joy of activity. It seeks to initiate, aggravate, arouse, inspire, conquer and command; to set things in motion or explore virgin territory. It is endlessly creative, but too impatient to complete any task. Aries has a very strong sense of identity and an overweening attitude of self-importance; "me first!" Since it is intolerant of obstacles it frequently causes conflict and wars. It is not very sympathetic, for it hates weakness. It has missionary zeal as if possessed by a god. It is independent, self-reliant and full of new ideas. It has an endless thirst for experience and lust for life. It is the sign of the eternal warrior; often the champion of the underdog. Aries is courageous, aggressive, energetic, optimistic, enterprising, pioneering, temperamental, fearless, headstrong, impulsive, rash, rude, reckless, rebellious, sporty, sensual, competitive, combative. All signs rule a part of the body. For Aries, it is the head, since the Ram likes to butt its head against the wall.

Famous (and historic) Arians include: J.S.Bach, Pierre Baudelaire, Otto von Bismarck, Marlon Brando, Jerry Brown, Cesar Chavez, Chuck Connors, Clarence Darrow, Rene Descartes, James Garner, Vincent Van Gogh, Al Gore, Francisco Goya, Joseph Haydn, Henry II, Edmund Husserl, Thomas Jefferson, Nikita Khrushchev, David Letterman, Eugene McCarthy, J.P. Morgan, Modest Mussorgsky, Napoleon III (Taurus cusp), Leonard Nimoy, Sandra Day O'Connor, Gregory Peck, Colin Powell, Diana Ross, Peter Ustinov.

TAURUS, the Bull. Second sign of the zodiac, April 21-May 20. Fixed earth sign; ruler, Venus. Motto: "I have." Taurus steadies the originating impulse of Aries and gives it a secure and lasting foundation. Though it is less creative than Aries, it knows how to consolidate and put things to good use. Very resourceful, perceptive and alert for good business opportunities, it seeks to maximize profit through reliance on its own talents. It is fortunate with money and generates great wealth; it can be very materialistic and acquisitive. Taurus is stubborn, powerful and determined; the strong, silent type. It has the strength of purpose to see a project through to the end as does no other sign. Sometimes it is cruel toward those who stand in its way. It makes excellent builders, architects, artists, civil engineers. Its purpose is to introduce order and placidity; it is the sign of peace and plenty. Therefore it can be very stagnant, conservative, lazy, complacent, traditional. It feels deep kinship with the earth; it is the sign of fertility rites and the pleasures of the flesh. Taurus is calm, patient, slow, sensuous, down-to-earth, affectionate, indulgent, confident. Taurus rules the neck and throat; the world's best singers are born under this sign.

Famous Taureans: Johannes Brahms, Georges Bracque, Buddha (Siddhartha Gautama), Judy Collins, Oliver Cromwell, Bing Crosby, Salvador Dali, Leonardo da Vinci, Eugene Delacroix, Elizabeth II, Ella Fitzgerald, Sigmund Freud, U.S. Grant, Adolf Hitler (Aries cusp), Saddam Hussein, Pope John Paul II, Immanuel Kant, Soren Kierkegaard, Lenin, Jay Leno, Malcolm X,

Karl Marx, George McGovern, Prince Metternich, Jack Nicholson, Maximilien Robespierre, Socrates, Benjamin Spock, Barbra Streisand, Tchaikovsky, Harry Truman.

GEMINI, the Twins. Third sign of the zodiac, May 21-June 20. Mutable air sign; ruler, Mercury. Motto: "I think." Gemini coordinates the opposing forces of the two previous signs. It represents curiosity about the immediate environment; the urge to learn and communicate. Gemini loves novelty and is extremely versatile; it adjusts quickly to circumstance and can juggle many things at once. It is quick-witted, restless, very inventive and mentally brilliant; but it lacks depth and can become a dilettante, "the jack of all trades and master of none." Gemini is the awareness of relationships and connections; the sign of synthesis. It has to do with travel, writing, education, schools, journalists, thought, ideas, trade, networking. Geminis are sociable, cheerful, agile, energetic, flexible, youthful, loquacious, scattered, intellectual, logical, liberal, cultured, objective. Gemini rules the arms and hands, shoulders, lungs.

Famous Geminis: Raymond Burr, George H.W. Bush, Maurice Chevalier, Mario Cuomo, Dante Alighieri, A. C. Doyle, Bob Dylan, R.W. Emerson, Michael J. Fox, Judy Garland, Paul Gauguin, George III, Newt Gingrich, Andy Griffith, Bob Hope, Elbert Hubbard, Hubert Humphrey, Henry Jackson, John F. Kennedy, Henry Kissinger, Thomas Mann, Paul McCartney, Bill Moyers, Lawrence Olivier, Charles A. Reich, Oswald Spengler, Igor Stravinsky, Queen Victoria, Richard Wagner.

CANCER, the Crab. Fourth sign of the zodiac, June 21-July 21. Cardinal water sign; ruler, The Moon. Motto: "I feel." Cancer introduces personal meanings and values into experience. It represents the urge to build a home and a secure refuge. It is the sign of "to have and to hold;" of what is most intimate and unique. It is family, heritage, veneration of ancestors, nationalism, racism and patriotism. Yet it also has a restless wanderlust and thirst for experience. This creates inner conflict and a desire to grow emotionally. Cancer is the sensitive underside of life; the subconscious mind, feelings, instincts. It is very intuitive, imaginative, illogical; many poets and painters are born under this sign. It always seeks to nurture, conserve and preserve life; also to protect the rights of the individual, property and the common people. It is talented at managing others and providing basic needs. Cancers are tenacious, emotional, timid, defensive, cautious, introverted, shy, sympathetic, sensitive, sentimental, humorous, sensation-seeking, acquisitive, economical, stingy, crabby, temperamental, subjective, nostalgic, cherishing, clinging, domestic, motherly, gentle, feminine, receptive, moody, changeable as the tides. Cancer rules the stomach.

Famous Cancers: Les Aspin, Milton Berle, John Bradshaw, David Brinkley, George W. Bush, Calvin Coolidge, Bill Cosby, Tom Cruise, Bob Dole, Mary Baker Eddy, Gerald Ford, Stephen Foster, John Glenn, Merv Griffin, Henry VIII, Hermann Hesse, Helen Keller, Thurgood Marshall, Ross Perot, Rembrandt van Rijn, Jean Jacques Rousseau, Jean Paul Sartre, Red Skelton, Sylvester Stallone, Ringo Starr, Meryl Streep, Robin Williams.

LEO, the Lion. Fifth sign of the zodiac, July 22-August 21. Fixed fire sign; ruler, The Sun. Motto: "I will." Leo expresses and dramatizes the confidence and power of the individual. Its purpose is to grow through testing itself against experience. Leos radiate warmth to everyone around them;

they love to give and receive affection and adulation and always enjoy being the center of attention, and their vibrant love of life is infectious. Their self-assurance and inward sense of nobility and grandeur make them great organizers and leaders, for people naturally feel confidence in them. Leos are stubborn, dogmatic, egotistic and guard their rights and prerogatives tenaciously. Leo is connected to all activities of youth, self-expression and risk-taking: theater, drama, sports, games, gambling, speculation, romance, education, entertainment, recreation. Leos are proud, creative, complacent, loyal, stable, conservative, flamboyant, romantic, optimistic, dramatic, frank, inspirational, willful, determined. Leo rules the heart and the spine.

Famous Leos: Neil Armstrong, Lucille Ball, Barry Bonds, Julius Caesar, Fidel Castro, Bill Clinton, Claude Debussy, Robert De Niro, Jerry Falwell, Henry Ford, Mata Hari, Dustin Hoffman, Herbert Hoover, Whitney Houston, Mick Jagger, Carl Jung, Norman Lear, Madonna, Benito Mussolini, Napoleon Bonaparte, Barack Obama, Carroll O'Connor, Jacqueline Kennedy Onassis, Peter O'Toole, Robert Redford, Jason Robards, H. Norman Schwarzkopf (Virgo cusp), Arnold Schwarzenegger, George Bernard Shaw, Percy Shelley, Patrick Swayze.

VIRGO, the Virgin. Sixth sign of the zodiac, August 22-September 22. Mutable earth sign; ruler, Mercury. Motto: "I analyze." Virgo refines the world of manifest form into perfection, and goes beyond Leo's pride to introduce a sense of duty to society. It takes care of all the details with which regal Leo can't be bothered. Virgo rules the humble classes: workers, servants, employees. It represents work and is connected to the military, civil service and bureaucracy; Virgos are natural administrators. The Virgo desire for perfection and order makes it prudish, obsessed with purity and efficiency; it is also uncomfortable with the unknown. These qualities make it the sign of technology and scientific research, but often it is myopic, "missing the forest for the trees." Its nagging instinct for criticism can be directed toward changing society to help the poor, sick and unfortunate; it has a powerful need to heal or serve others. It is the sign of hygiene, health, and welfare. Virgos are self-effacing, helpful, witty, adaptable, analytical, industrious, reliable, conventional, conforming, pedantic, nervous, anxious, self-critical, full of gossip. Virgo keeps things in good working order. It rules the intestines.

Famous Virgos: Shirley Booth, Stokely Carmichael, Sean Connery (Leo cusp), J.L. David, Elizabeth I, Peter Falk, Alan Funt, Greta Garbo, Johann W. Goethe, Stephen Jay Gould, G.W.F. Hegel, Michael Jackson, Lyndon Johnson, Gene Kelly, Charles Kuralt, Louis XIV and XVI, John McCain, H.L. Mencken, Sam Nunn, Walter Reuther, Peter Sellers, Upton Sinclair, David Souter, Robert Taft, William H. Taft, Leo Tolstoy, Mel Torme, George Wallace (Leo cusp).

LIBRA, the Scales. Seventh sign of the zodiac, September 23-October 22. Cardinal air sign; ruler, Venus. Motto: "I balance." At Libra, life's outward thrust begins to yield and turn inward as it seeks wider and deeper relationships. Libra is permeated by the sense of form, harmony and atmosphere; it is the most cultured, refined, artistic and musical of the signs, representing the classical ideal of balance in all things. It has a strong sense of justice and fairness and takes the initiative to bring it about through negotiation. Libra seeks partnership; it rules marriage, divorce, relationships, diplomacy, open legal affairs, contracts, alliances; it is the sign of war as well as peace. It becomes too dependent on others and apt to use them for their own ends. It constantly

evaluates and sees both sides of an issue, but is often indecisive; it can artfully evade responsibility. Librans are charming, graceful, imaginative, idealistic, sociable, even-tempered, peaceful, lazy, discriminating, opportunistic, competitive, calculating; Libra rules the kidneys and loins.

Famous Librans: Brigitte Bardot, Henri Bergson, Chuck Berry, Annie Besant, Jimmy Carter, Ray Charles, Dwight D. Eisenhower, John Kenneth Galbraith, Mohandas K. Gandhi, Art Garfunkel, George Gershwin, Rutherford B. Hayes, Martin Heidegger, Lee Iacocca, Jesse Jackson, Angela Lansbury, Timothy Leary, John Lennon, Franz Liszt, Groucho Marx, Bob Newhart, Friedrich Nietzsche, Eugene O'Neill, Richard III, Eleanor Roosevelt, Bruce Springsteen, Giuseppe Verdi, Barbara Walters.

SCORPIO, the Scorpion. Eighth sign of the zodiac, October 23-November 21. Fixed water sign; rulers, Mars and Pluto. Motto: "I desire." Scorpio takes us deeper into the unmanifest; it is, according to Celtic mythology, the time of year when the boundary between this world and the next is the thinnest. Scorpio is the most passionate, turbulent and strong-willed sign. It seeks to penetrate beneath the surface to understand how things work; it loves to probe the mysteries. Keenly aware of death and its own vulnerability, it has unflinching determination and stamina; it is uncompromising in the struggle against its enemies and the quest of its desires. But it finds it must let go of these jealous obsessions and transform itself in order to attain its goals (whereupon it becomes the Eagle). It is thus the sign of spiritual rebirth. Scorpio is about restructuring, reorganizing and regenerating; it is where relationships are consolidated and resources are invested. It represents communion, where we lose our souls to find them in others. Scorpions are intense, combative, introspective, courageous, magnetic, dramatic, sensual, thorough, quiet, thoughtful, controlled, vengeful, critical, sarcastic, indomitable, suspicious, scheming, often sympathetic, at best highly ethical. Scorpio rules the sex organs.

Famous Scorpions: Spiro Agnew, Marie Antoinette, Howard Baker, Alexander Borodin, Pat Buchanan, Richard Burton, Hillary Clinton, Richard Dreyfus, Michael Dukakis, Billy Graham, Katharine Hepburn, Robert Kennedy, Martin Luther, Charles Manson, Burgess Meredith, Claude Monet, William of Orange, Pablo Picasso, Dan Rather, Theodore Roosevelt, Carl Sagan, Pat Sajak, Grace Slick, Leon Trotsky, Oscar Wilde.

SAGITTARIUS, the Centaur. Ninth sign of the zodiac, November 22- December 20. Mutable fire sign; ruler, Jupiter. Motto: "I see." Sagittarius seeks to expand its horizons widely in order to find wisdom. It is the sign of philosophy, the higher mind, higher education, publishing, the press, organized religion, the law, diplomacy, flight. It makes far-flung connections between people and ideas and travels to foreign lands. Well adjusted to society, it is buoyant, benevolent, exuberant; but it also insists loudly on freedom for itself and others. It loves the outdoors and hates to be pinned down. Identified with Humanity, it feels entitled to speak for it. Honest and outspoken, Sagittarius reveals the truth openly regardless of consequences. The archer "cares not where it shoots its arrows." It thinks big, takes long chances and tends to exaggerate its achievements. Sagittarius is daring, adventurous, sociable, optimistic, idealistic, visionary, prophetic, impatient, careless, restless, argumentative, self-righteous, arrogant, snobbish, sporty, ambitious, enterprising. It rules the hips and thighs.

Famous Sagittarians: Woody Allen, Ludwig van Beethoven, Hector Berlioz, William Blake, William F. Buckley, Andrew Carnegie, Winston Churchill, Charles De Gaulle, Walt Disney, Benjamin Disraeli, Kirk Douglas, Dick Van Dyke, Francisco Franco, Theodore Gericault, Jimi Hendrix, John F. Kerry, Bette Midler, Rod Serling, Paul Simon, Alexander Solzhenitsyn, Strom Thurmond, Tina Turner, Mark Twain, Voltaire.

CAPRICORN, the Goat. Tenth sign of the zodiac, December 21- January 19. Cardinal earth sign; ruler, Saturn. Motto: "I use." Capricorn steadies the far-ranging exuberance of Sagittarius. Its aim is to achieve status and solid worldly achievement. Capricorns are very good organizers, ambitious and interested in politics. Conscientious and realistic, Capricorn meets many obstacles in its path and succeeds by overcoming them with patient, consistent, methodical efforts. It is very persistent and single-minded and usually does things the hard way. Capricorns prefer tradition, age and experience. They have high integrity and can be relied upon, unless and until they use or exploit others for their own ends. Often insensitive and impersonal, Capricorn looks only at results. "Winning isn't everything, it's the only thing." Yet its ultimate goal is to accomplish things for the good of society and Humanity. It represents all large organizations and central authorities. Capricorn is practical, solitary, serious, conservative, industrious, focused, sensual, strong, introspective, logical, rigid, dark, enduring, structured, obstinate, bigoted, pessimistic; it rules the bones and knees.

Famous Capricorns: Conrad Adenauer, boxer Muhammed Ali, Joan Baez, George Burns, Paul Cezanne, John Denver, Everett Dirksen, Ben Franklin, Barry Goldwater, Alexander Hamilton, J. Edgar Hoover, Howard Hughes, William James, King John, Andrew Johnson, Janis Joplin, Martin Luther King, Rudyard Kipling, Rush Limbaugh, Mao Tse Tung, Walter Mondale, Mary Tyler Moore, Issac Newton, Richard Nixon, Luis Pasteur, Elvis Prestley, Albert Schweitzer, Robert Stack, Joseph Stalin, Woodrow Wilson.

AQUARIUS, the Water Bearer. Eleventh sign of the zodiac, January 20-February 18. Fixed Air sign; rulers Uranus, Saturn. Motto: "I know." Aquarius shares and distributes knowledge on behalf of Humanity. It challenges the prerogatives of authority and beckons us to embrace the new and unfamiliar. Very scientific, it seeks to understand the world so that it may re-invent it. Like Leo it radiates a brilliant light, but one of knowledge and friendship toward all. Aquarians are very charismatic leaders and entertainers, masters of electronic media and group dynamics. It is the sign of fraternities and associations dedicated to idealistic causes. Aquarians are non-conformists, but not egotists; they are objective, detached and unemotional, yet expectant for a better tomorrow. They function spasmodically and are very unpredictable. Aquarians are original, intellectual, independent, humorous, brilliant, magnetic, friendly, humane, eccentric, touchy, rebellious, perverse, abrupt, tactless, doctrinaire, dictatorial, contrary. Aquarius rules the legs and ankles.

Famous Aquarians: Alan Alda, Jack Benny, Lord Byron, Charles Darwin, Charles Dickens, Thomas Edison, Clark Gable, Galileo Galilei, Richard Gephardt, Jack Lemmon, Sinclair Lewis, Abraham Lincoln, Norman Mailer, Felix Mendelssohn, W.A. Mozart, Paul Newman, Sarah Palin, James A. Pike, Plato, Ronald Reagan, Franklin Roosevelt, Babe Ruth, Tom Selleck, Tommy Smothers, Paul Tsongas, Oprah Winfrey, Boris Yeltsin.

PISCES, the Fishes. Twelfth sign of the zodiac, February 19-March 20. Mutable water sign; rulers Neptune, Jupiter. Motto: "I believe." As the zodiac's "grand finale," Pisces seeks to understand and identify with the whole of creation and find ultimate salvation. It senses the undercurrents and underlying unity of life; in Pisces the veil is lifted that we may gaze once more upon our original spiritual nature. It is fermenting chaos that incubates new birth. Chameleon-like, it wishes to be part of all, but not to define or enclose itself; it seeks escape from the limits of matter and form. This gives it a large capacity to turn away from responsibility and to deceive itself and others; it is the sign of scandal, delusion, decay, degradation and self-undoing. Its compulsive empathy makes it the most compassionate, altruistic sign; its urge to escape becomes self-sacrifice. Unsure in this life, it has unwavering faith in the next; but its ideals can be tragically disillusioned. It is the sign of religion, fantasy, mysticism, imagination, surrealism, music, dreams, illusions, subtle theories and abstract thinking. Pisces is "Macawber" or "the absent-minded professor;" fluid, romantic, affectionate, spiritual, malleable, vacillating, versatile, adaptable, sentimental, moody. It rules the feet.

Famous Pisceans: George Berkeley, William Jennings Bryan, Frederic Chopin, Billy Crystal, Albert Einstein, Mikhail Gorbachev, G.F. Handel, George Harrison, Rex Harrison, L. Ron Hubbard, Jesus of Nazareth (?), Ted Kennedy, Patrick McGoochan (Aries cusp), Michaelangelo Buonarroti, Daniel P. Moynihan, Ralph Nader, Linus Pauling, Maurice Ravel, Nicholas Rimsky-Korsakov, Bedrich Smetana, Elizabeth Taylor, George Washington.

Additional sign meanings: the first and last 5 degrees of a sign is the cusp; it has traits of both signs. The first four signs are concerned with primordial instincts, the second four with personal (or international) relationships and the final four with larger or universal matters. Finally, notice how each sign complements and contrasts with its opposite half way around the Zodiac, and also supplies much of what's missing in the previous sign.

The Sun travels one degree of the zodiac in about one day. Therefore each of the 360 degrees of the zodiac is important, and each has its own peculiar meaning. In this book we occasionally refer to the series of Sabian symbols to reveal the significance of each degree. They were developed by Marc Edmund Jones and Dane Rudhyar from a series of pictures given to Jones by a San Diego psychic (see Rudhyar, *An Astrological Mandala*).

ASPECTS

the planets move around the zodiac they also move in relation to each other, forming all possible angles between themselves. Certain of these angles are very basic and significant; they are called aspects. In fact, they are probably the most important thing in astrology; certainly in cultural or mundane astrology.

The most familiar and basic aspects are the New Moon and Full Moon, and the cycle of relationship between them is called the lunation cycle. The New Moon is a conjunction between Sun and Moon as seen from the Earth. At the New Moon the cycle is just beginning; new energy is stirring, but the Moon's light is hidden and withdrawn from us. As the cycle proceeds the Moon's light gradually increases (or waxes) through the crescent, first quarter and gibbous

phases. At the Full Moon the cycle climaxes, and the Moon's light shines brilliantly and clearly. Then it gradually decreases through its waning gibbous, last quarter and balsamic phases until the cycle ends at the next new moon.

A special kind of lunation is an eclipse. In this case the Sun and Moon are so closely aligned with the Earth that their light is blocked out. Eclipses are more important than other lunations, and their "influence" lasts far longer (for a solar eclipse, about the same length in years that the eclipse lasts in minutes).

All the planets go through phases with each other just like the Sun and Moon do. In the waxing phases fortunes rise and new structures are built. In the waning phases structures may rigidify and decay, but ideas and group activities increase. The following are the most important aspects, or phases, in the cycles between planets:

The **conjunction** (0 degree angle) is like a New Moon; it is an alignment of planets, usually in the same sign. During important conjunctions explosive events erupt spontaneously, and daring new initiatives are taken in fields represented by the two planets. Their energies are powerfully combined, concentrated and intensified. The aims and direction of the new cycle remains unclear, and often the most crucial changes unleashed by a conjunction remain hidden until later.

The **opposition** (180 degree angle, 1/2 of the circle) is like a Full Moon, and planets are usually 6 signs apart on opposite sides of the Earth. It brings fulfillment of what began at the conjunction, but also a schism or polarization into two opposing sides. The opposition usually indicates major events in a very powerful and obvious way. People know clearly what they're doing and why, but may be locked in a frustrating stalemate.

The **square** (90 degree angle, 1/4 of the circle) is like the first or last quarter phase. Planets are at right angles to each other, usually 3 signs apart in signs of the same quality. Together with the conjunction and opposition, the squares are the most critical phases of the cycle. The two planets are "squaring off" with each other, producing tension, crisis, conflict and dynamic activity. During a square people stir up trouble and important decisions must be made. Dangerous events tend to occur. Square and opposition aspects are also called "afflictions."

The **trine** (120 degree angle, 1/3 of the circle) is like a gibbous phase. Here planets are about 4 signs apart in signs of the same element. Under trines events move quickly and people are lively and confident. A flood of light and energy is released and good fortune may result. The trine gives us a wider perspective, but it often indicates that we are being frivolous, wasteful or complacent.

The **sextile** (60 degree angle, 1/6 of the circle) is like a crescent phase. In this aspect the planets are 2 signs apart, usually in signs of the same gender. Like the trine, it tends to be a fortunate aspect. When it occurs people are more creative, intelligent and productive. It may indicate a crisis, but important events move more smoothly.

The semi-square (45 degree angle, 1/8 of the circle) is one half of a square. It is an aspect of friction and dynamic, constructive activity.

The sesqui-square (135 degree angle, 3/8 of a circle) is a square plus one half. It also generates activity and frequently brings upheaval. It is especially dangerous during a waning phase.

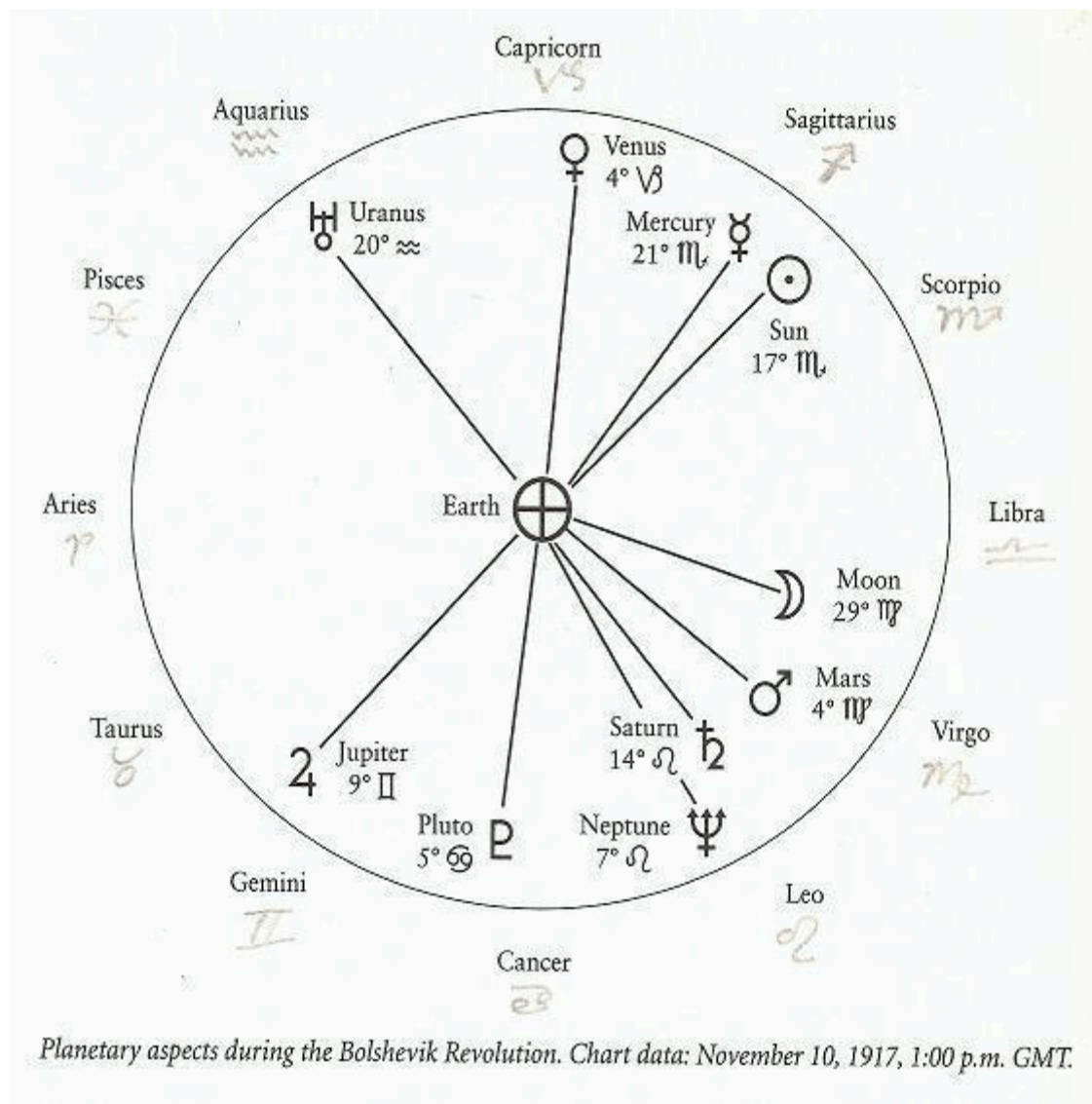
The quincunx (150 degree angle) may contribute to trials and tribulations that force us to make adjustments or confront uncomfortable karmic issues. In this aspect the planets are usually 5 signs apart.

The semi-sextile (30 degree angle) puts planets one sign apart and acts like a weaker sextile. It may show a phase of growth, or perhaps events that lead to larger ones at the time of the following sextile or conjunction.

Orbs. When exact, an aspect is at its peak of significance. Before exactitude the forces and events it indicates are building up. After exactitude the energy is released and distributed, often becoming more destructive. The orb, or amount of inexactness, allowed for lunations (such as Sun-Moon conjunctions) is at least 12 degrees. For conjunctions, oppositions, trines and squares it is up to 10 degrees, and for sextiles up to 7. For semi and sesqui-squares it is 3 degrees and for semi-sextiles and quincunxes 2 degrees. The closer an aspect is, the more important it is. Astrologers don't always agree on allowable orbs.

Aspect patterns. At any given moment there is more than one cycle unfolding, and thus more than one aspect going on. In fact, there is a whole pattern of them forming at all times. When a greater number of important aspects are happening than usual, it means the "cosmic weather" is more active; big events or the start of major trends can be expected!

For example, below is the whole pattern of aspects that prevailed during the Bolshevik Revolution in Russia in November, 1917. You can see Saturn and Neptune in conjunction in Leo, with Uranus opposing them from Aquarius; while the Sun and Mercury in Scorpio square all three. This is undoubtedly a powerful aspect pattern corresponding to an important event!



Notice that the signs are always arranged counterclockwise around the edge of the circle. When reading any chart or illustration, remember there are 30 degrees in every sign. Next to the symbol for a planet, there will usually be a number followed by a sign; this indicates which degree of a sign the planet is in. If the planet is in 2 Aries, for example, it is near the beginning of the sign; if it is in 15 Aries, it is in the middle; in 29 Aries it is near the end and about to enter the next sign (Taurus). A good way to spot aspects is to notice which degrees the planets are in. One planet that is in nearly the same degree of any sign as another planet is making an aspect to that planet.

FOCAL POINTS

In some cases intense significance is focused on one key planet or several planets. The most important of these focal points happens when a planet passes closest to the Earth. At this critical moment it appears to turn **stationary** and then move retrograde (backwards through the

Zodiac). Soon afterward, the planet turns stationary again and begins to move direct. When a planet turns stationary, its energy here on Earth is strongly intensified. While retrograde its expression is inhibited and turned intensely inward toward the subconscious. The stations of Mars and Mercury are especially important, and often trigger events shortly afterward.

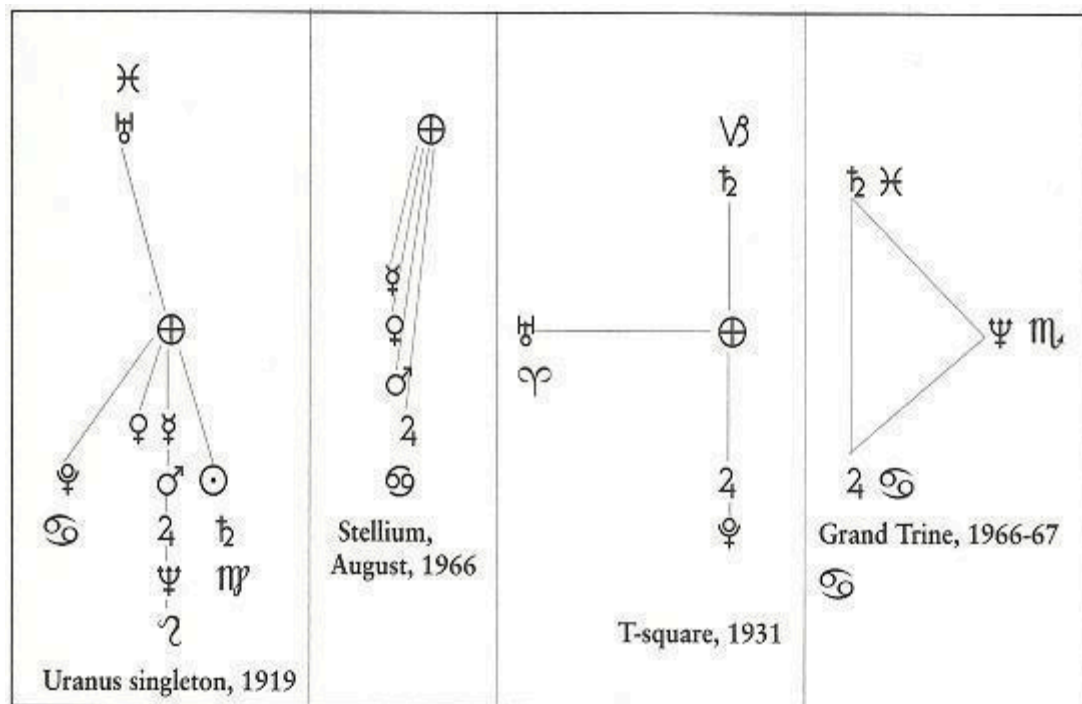
Retrograde planets are often marked "R." "SR" means the planet is turning stationary-retrograde; "SD" means stationary-direct.

Cyclic patterns are very significant in interpreting and predicting events, as we have already seen. Similar or related events will often occur when a planet returns to the same place it was in at the time of an earlier event.

Another very significant pattern is the singleton. In this case a planet occupies over half the sky by itself. You can be sure that if one planet is on one side of the sky, and all the others are on the other side, it is highly significant. Everything is focused on the functions of that planet and the sign it's in. The illustration below shows Uranus in Pisces as a singleton in 1919 and the early 1920s.

Other focal points occur when several planets are grouped together in strong mutual aspects. The easiest of these patterns to spot is the stellium, where several planets are clumped close together, all in conjunction. A stellium always portends great events, but they rarely occur immediately because the energy of the planets is so tightly bound up. Whatever happens will strongly reflect the meaning of the sign in which the stellium occurred.

A very tense situation is indicated when one planet squares off with two others that are opposing each other. This is called a T-square and happened, for example, in the early 1930s. Even more rare and powerful is the grand cross, formed by two oppositions in square to each other. Three planets each 120 degrees apart form a grand trine, releasing keen, exhilarating energy that can bring great fortune but easily runs out of control (or "carried away"). The element in which the grand trine occurs is emphasized. A good example of a powerful, influential grand trine happened in 1966-67 in the emotional water signs as the feelings and passions of the 60s were unleashed. Another grand trine in water signs happened during the "roaring '20s." The focal points are illustrated in the following diagram:



Examples of Significant Planetary Configurations in the Twentieth Century

READING HOROSCOPES: the angles

The word horoscope means viewing the hour. A horoscope shows us where the planets were at a particular time, allowing us to estimate the fortunes of a new enterprise or nation begun at that moment. For example, we can erect a horoscope for the United States of America for the time when the Declaration of Independence was signed on July 4, 1776. Or we can focus on the personal horoscope of the current president or other world leaders. Watching when planets make aspects to (or "contact") the positions of planets in one of these important charts can tell us when events might occur that affect the nation or leader in question. Horoscopes can also be cast for the time of a lunation, eclipse or conjunction. These help us to determine where events might occur, as well as to understand their long-range significance.

To read most horoscope figures in this book, you only need to be able to locate the key points: the horizon, and the zenith (or point overhead). The Midheaven (MH) (or zenith) is always at the top of the chart. The Ascendant (Asc) is always at the line on the left and represents the Eastern horizon, where the Sun and planets rise at that locality. The opposing points to these are significant too. The line leading to the right of the chart is the Descendant and shows where the Sun and planets set at that locality. The line running to the bottom of the chart represents the Nadir, or the point directly beneath our feet. These points in the sky are called "angles." Since they are the most important or "cardinal" points of the horoscope, any planets and signs which are located on or near these angles are considered the most significant and powerful in the chart.

The **Ascendant** (Asc.) or Eastern horizon shows which forces are rising or "in the Ascendant." It signifies the personality, health and attitude of the individual or nation being represented. Planets there can represent daring actions or merely outspoken, aggressive and violent behavior. The Ascendant corresponds to where the Sun is at Dawn.

The **Midheaven** (MH), or point overhead, stands for the authority in the "high" seat of power. Planets or signs there may indicate which trends are dominant at that location or show who or what has reached the zenith of fortune there. In a personal chart it represents career and worldly ambitions. The Midheaven corresponds to where the Sun is at Noon.

The **Descendant** (Desc.) or Western horizon may show what is on the wane. More often it shows the other people or nations to be contended with, including a nation's enemies (whether real or perceived). Aggressive planets on the Descendant often stand for war or warlike attitudes, including civil war and divorce. It also represents diplomacy and efforts to adjust disputes. Planets here can signify people speaking out in public scandals. The Descendant corresponds to where the Sun is at Sunset.

The **Nadir**, or low point, represents "the nadir of fortune." It also indicates what is private and personal rather than public. Thus it stands for the home, family heritage and the land. In political terms this means nationalism, racism, defense, "family values" or, in more advanced times, environmentalism. It stands for turning inward to spiritual life and rejecting the public world. Planets here can represent a sharp challenge to the ruling authorities. The Nadir corresponds to where the Sun is at Midnight.

The vertical and horizontal axes of the horoscope divide it into hemispheres. The upper hemisphere above the horizon is objective, public or concerned with wider issues, while the lower hemisphere is subjective, private and more narrowly focused. The left side of the chart is self-assertive, independent and rational, while the right side is concerned with relationships and is feeling or sensation oriented.

THE HOUSES OF THE HOROSCOPE

The horoscope figure is further divided into twelve "houses." Whether in a personal or mundane map, the houses represent the 12 "departments of life." They are closely related to the 12 signs and have corresponding meanings. Note that the meanings of the houses also apply to the signs which are linked to them.

The First House takes its meaning from the Ascendant, and so represents the self, the people and their behavior (see "Ascendant" above). It is linked to Aries.

The Second House represents all financial affairs, desires for stability, constructive talents, financial independence and values. It is linked to Taurus.

The Third House represents travel, communications, trade, journalism, the media, the mind, writings, intellectuals, education, youth, ideas, speech, neighbors, relatives. It is linked to Gemini.

The Fourth House takes its meaning from the Nadir, as outlined above. Thus it represents home, family, ethnic pride, the personal and national soul, the land, the weather, etc. It is linked to Cancer and all it stands for.

The Fifth House represents self-expression, youth, romance, pleasures, financial speculation, sports, games, children, education, ambitions for power, imperial expansion, the Senate, royalty, nobility. It is linked to Leo.

The Sixth House is public health, welfare, work, civil and military service, bureaucrats, employees, labor unions, servants, armed forces. It is linked to Virgo.

The Seventh House takes its meaning from the Descendant (see above) and rules international relations, diplomacy, politics, war, disputes, legal affairs, marriage, divorce, contracts, enemies, public scandals. It is linked to Libra.

The Eighth House rules financial dealings, corporations, taxes, insurance, mortgages, inheritance, group management of funds, communes and communism, stock markets, debts. It also stands for deaths, rebirth, reconstruction, renewal, the occult. It is linked to Scorpio.

The Ninth House rules foreign affairs, trade, distant travels, higher education, philosophy, the law, the courts, the Church, prophecy. It is linked to Sagittarius.

The Tenth House takes its meaning from the Midheaven (see above). Thus it stands for the government, the executive, public life, etc. It is linked to Capricorn.

The Eleventh House represents group cooperation, idealistic associations, the legislature (lower house), government finance, social programs, theater, friends, hopes for the future, profitable inventions. It is linked to Aquarius.

The Twelfth House rules national karma, hidden forces out of control, secret enemies, big institutions, prisons, asylums, monasteries, hospitals, occult interests, spirituality, exile, the search for refuge and self-renewal. It is linked to Pisces.

The idea that there is a "ladder of planets" has been covered on some of my other pages, as well as in Robert Place's book on [The Tarot](#). Many ancient mystics used the planets to contemplate a "ladder" from the earth to heaven, where they believed higher consciousness could be found. They postulated that the soul came down to earth to be born on this ladder, and would return by climbing it back, and that through contemplation they could anticipate this journey. At each planet they would receive or release certain traits. Thus each planet, even then, was thought of as a "stage" on the way from ordinary consciousness to the divine. This is just what Spiral Dynamics wishes to show has been happening on a larger scale through human evolution and history.

Let's review briefly **the meaning of the planets in astrology**, climbing up as we go the ladder of planets one way. There are two directions in which to climb the ladder, and *each direction* or current can be interpreted as taking us either up toward the divine or downward toward

manifestation on Earth. Unlike in the chakra system, in Spiral Dynamics the order of the planets seems to fit the climb outward to the stars, rather than the climb inward from the dark outer planets to the Sun or the Earth. This *may* be because this is a collective, rather than just an individual ascent. So that is the direction we will climb the ladder now. The symbol or glyph for each planet is also indicated.

 **The Sun** is the center of the solar system, the basic source of our life and energy. It represents the glory attributed to the Father-God Creator or to the creative force of life. It is noble, dramatic and expressive.

 **The Moon** represents our instincts, emotions and feelings. Symbol of family and the Mother goddess, she nourishes life and provides for basic needs. More unstable than the Sun, the Moon reflects the Sun's rays and rules the fluctuating tides. It appears to wax and wane in its light.

 **Mercury** is named after the ancient God Hermes or Thoth. He is the Magician who brings knowledge to humanity. He is the winged messenger who represents writing, communication and rational thought. Mercury symbolizes brethren and neighbors as well as short journeys.

 **Venus** is the goddess of love and the productive powers of nature who represents the sensuous allure of feminine beauty and sexuality. She represents art, but also money and values generally. She brings diplomacy and peace, and she balances and evaluates.

 **Mars** is the god of war. He stirs up trouble and rouses us to action and adventure. Mars represents conquest and the courage and strategic skill to defend against our enemies. He represents male sexual desire, and the strong sense of ego and individuality. He gives us the energy and desire to fight inner battles as well as outer ones.

 **Jupiter** is the jolly giant among the planets. He brings us wealth, wisdom, and celebration in pageantry, ceremony and ritual. Jupiter expands our perspective so that we can understand the moral laws that govern society. Jupiter represents organized religion and the priesthood as well as philosophy and the Higher Mind generally. He is the ultimate "joiner," but also sends us on long journeys and travels. He has the exuberant faith and confidence to dream and act big.

 **Saturn** represents law and order. Where Jupiter is the Church, Saturn is the State. Saturn organizes, controls and restricts us. He sets boundaries and rules. Saturn is very realistic, worldly, pessimistic, practical and down-to-earth; the teacher and task-master. Saturn is ambitious and seeks status and power. He is the god of old age and Father Time, and the favorite of kings, high officials and petty bureaucrats. People ruled by Saturn are thinkers who follow well-trod procedures and formulas, and may be dogmatic or limited in their outlook to what is traditional or strictly demonstrated by science and precedent.

[Here is a great introduction to the meaning and evolution within humanity of these inner visible planets on you tube](#) by Vic DiCara

♅ **Uranus** is the revolutionary, awakener and non-conformist. Discovered in 1781, the year the United States won its independence on the eve of the French Revolution, Uranus is the planet of liberty and freedom, and the champion of individual rights and progress. It thus represents the power of the Middle Class or Bourgeoisie unleashed by the revolutions both political and industrial, and its competitive individualism and self-reliance, but also of all those who continue to rebel against established authorities-- even those who were once the revolutionaries themselves. This fact is what gave Hegel his idea about conflict and synthesis through history, which was passed on to Karl Marx. Uranus is inventive, investigates both science and the occult, and looks outside the boxes and boundaries set by Saturn. He represents the unexpected and overturns lots of applecarts. Uranus is the inner light of discovery. It is equivalent in meaning to Rahu in Vedic astrology.

♆ **Neptune**, discovered in 1846, represents the social advances of the 19th Century, just as Uranus represents those of the 18th. It has always been associated by astrologers with socialism and communism and other programs intended to help the poor and the working class. It is the symbol of boundless compassion and the genuine humanitarian attitudes and activities that emerged in the period of its discovery. It also represents the yearnings of the mystic to seek spiritual enlightenment and dissolve and transcend boundaries and limits. It extends migration and commerce all over the globe. It represents greatly heightened sensitivity, expressed in the most subtle art forms, but also escapism through alcoholism, drugs, deceit, or other forms of decadence. It is equivalent to the Vedic Ketu.

♇ **Pluto**, discovered in 1930, is the planet of the 20th Century, and the god of all forbidden fruits of the Underworld. It represents vast cycles of death and rebirth in civilization and its power structures. It plumbs the depths to release explosive, pent-up, hidden powers in order to bring new life into the world. Depth psychology and Existentialism, as well as bioenergetics, relativity, quantum physics and atomic energy, are typical Plutonian manifestations. It destroys the old to make way for the new. Whereas Uranus awakens us with new insight, and Neptune expands our consciousness to the ultimate limits, Pluto gives us the persistence and concentration we need for spiritual practice. Pluto forces us to confront nothingness so that we may become transformed and renewed. It brought a holocaust/world war which also released unimagined wealth and power. By showing us the futility of polarization and atomic weapons, I think it is also a symbol of peace, and in its bent for transforming the old into the new, and its accent on interdependence, it stands for ecology, recycling and alternative energy.

Uranus, Neptune and Pluto, which are invisible to the naked eye (though a "sharp-eyed observer" can see Uranus), orbit in a 1-2-3 resonance. This means that it takes Neptune about twice as long to orbit the Sun (165 years) as Uranus does (84 years); and Pluto takes 3 times as long (248 years). So I have called them the [transcendental trinity](#). See the chapter called

[Prophetic Tool Kit](#) from my 1997 book *Horoscope for the New Millennium* for more on these and the visible planets.



As of this writing in 2008-2010 there is controversy over *whether Pluto is a planet*. This is because in the 15 years before 2008 many other smaller bodies have been discovered far out in our solar system, orbiting in what is called the Kuiper Belt or even beyond, the region where comets come from. One of these objects, (*Eris*) may be as big as Pluto. Even in 1930, one astronomer forecast that Pluto was just one of many objects in its region. In *defending Pluto's status*, I say that none of these other bodies has such a large Moon (*Charon*; the two together may be larger than *Eris*). Pluto's relationship with Charon is astounding, and confirms much of what is said about Pluto by astrologers. They are "locked together" more closely than any other bodies in the solar system. Charon orbits Pluto and rotates on its own axis at exactly the same rate; about 6-plus Earth days. Pluto also rotates on its axis at the same speed. Thus Charon is always in the same place in Pluto's sky, showing the same face, and Pluto is always in the same place in Charon's sky too. Imagine, if you were standing on Pluto, seeing the same side of a huge moon in the same place in the sky, day and night, year after year. This can represent obsession, concentration, power, polarization, structuring, synthesis, and inter-relationship or ecology, characteristics which astrologers noticed through their experience with Pluto in horoscopes even before Charon was discovered. For example, in Fritz Brunhubner's textbook on Pluto, written as early as 1934, and published by AFA in 1966, he described Pluto as "a polarity" which has "a double face" with "contrasts (which) combine." (p.13). Pluto's passage inside Neptune, far from disqualifying it, is one of the most powerful and historically-significant symbols in the solar system, representing rebirth. Pluto's recent closest passage to the Sun and Earth coincided with the greatest liberation the world has ever seen (the 1989-era movements), as I predicted it would.

Other planets also have other important minor planets crossing their orbits (for example, Chiron and the other centaurs cross Saturn, Uranus and Neptune). Neptune and Jupiter also have some objects that follow it around (Trojans). Given all this, it is hard to see how "clearing its orbital neighborhood" can be the definition of a planet, as is claimed, when all the other planets beyond Earth have not "cleared their orbits" either. It is, apparently, a matter of degree of "clearing" in relation to the size of the planet, and of how one defines the "neighborhood." In any case, *astrologers* certainly cannot dismiss Pluto, even if some astronomers don't call it a planet anymore; we know that its significance has been demonstrated beyond all doubt. The largest object in the Kuiper Belt, Pluto is the primary link or way-station between planets and minor planets, the planets and beyond, or life and after-life.

♄ **Chiron**, discovered in 1977, was the first "minor planet" besides the asteroids to be discovered after Pluto. Pluto's Moon *Charon* was discovered a year later. This icy asteroid called Chiron moves between the orbits of Saturn and Uranus, and even beyond them. It thus has been given the traits of a "rainbow bridge" or "key" between the visible and invisible realms by astrologers. Its discovery happened when many keys and tools of transformation emerged, both ancient and modern, within the New Age and Human Potential movements, as well as to when personal high tech began (Apple Computer was founded in 1977). Chiron is also called the "wounded healer," representing wisdom gained through integrating and healing the wounds and chaotic conditions of life. Similar objects to Chiron have been discovered since 1992 in the same area; they are called *centaurs*, since in mythology Chiron was a centaur. Several of them, including Chariklo and Pholus, are now believed to be larger than Chiron. They may continue in these orbits for only 1 to 10 million years, having descended from beyond Neptune and Pluto, perturbed by their orbits; after which they may fall below Jupiter and become comets.

The controversial reduction in status of Pluto to a [dwarf planet](#) occurred around 2006, just when politics in America seemed in *full retreat* from all the advances of the 20th Century (and it still is). Perhaps all of Pluto's forbidden fruits were being put back in the closet or buried underground again, even as Pluto began its trek back into the depths from its nearest passage to us in 1989. Thus everything from socialism, and its watered-down applications in America like the New Deal and the Great Society, to pluralism and tolerance of other religions, to restoring the environment, to releasing repressed and primitive energy, to spiritual awakening and cultural experiments, and above all the realizations of the peace movement, were all being denounced and destroyed by the Bush administration and the Republicans (and now even *more* clearly by Donald Trump). Even science was in retreat. Just as Pluto in its new lower status now has to fight for recognition, so do all the progressive advances of the 20th century.

On the other hand, all this regression, which had been building momentum since the late 1970s when Chiron and Charon were discovered, and launched in earnest by the ascension of the reactionary Ronald Reagan, might yet fulfill some purpose in the larger scheme of things. We can symbolize this with Chiron, since in effect it has put us back below Uranus again, with the aim of rediscovering some of the lost values of earlier memes. If one of these days, instead of just regressing and going back to them, as has been happening under Bush and the Republicans, we can *include and also transcend* these earlier stages, saving what is valuable and discarding the rest, then some healing of our nation and world could occur. Chiron "the wounded healer" centaur, and the other "centaurs," can thus symbolize the integration made possible by moving down from the transcendent memes in the invisible realms back into traditional memes in visible realms, while discovery of Eris and the Kuiper belt represents the "holistic" transcendent meme that is now in the ascendant.. Chiron also represents all the older ancient methods of esoteric knowledge, like astrology, the chakras, the kabbalah, and ancient mysticism and shamanism, now being rediscovered since at least the 1970s when Chiron was discovered.

The first object of the *Kuiper belt* after Pluto was discovered only in 1993. This Belt includes many objects similar to Pluto, all made of ice and rock, but smaller. About 1000 objects have

been found in it so far. That could be very symbolic, since the internet started the same year (also the year of Uranus' conjunction to Neptune). The vast Kuiper Belt reminds us of the "cloud" of computers now connecting our planet into one cyber-mind. Though many of these objects have a similar composition to Pluto, there is also great "diversity."

Eris, discovered in 2003, has a very ecliptic and uncircular orbit that takes it far beyond the Kuiper belt, and then back again inside the farthest reaches of Pluto's orbit. Eris is about as large as Pluto by itself (recent information is that it isn't "larger" than Pluto). It's discovery was the occasion for Pluto's demotion from planethood. It is said by astrologers to be "quarrelsome," which would fit in with the crazy and unnecessary Iraq War launched by Bush in 2003. But does Eris have a higher meaning, just as Pluto once stood for the holocaust and nuclear weapons, but now represents peace and ecology? Eris takes about 560 years to orbit the Sun. Some other smaller objects have similar orbits to Eris, and others may be found. It could be that, just as Chiron's discovery represented the start of regression that brought us below Neptune again in our consciousness (the Reagan reaction and the potential "integration" of older memes), so Eris' discovery in 2003 might represent the renewed questioning of the Reagan-Bush regression after Hurricane Katrina and the War in Iraq, and our resumed quest to expand our collective consciousness upward again and connect with the galaxy. Eris is considered one of the scattered disc objects, the next group beyond the Kuiper Belt, although like some others it also comes inside the Kuiper Belt toward its perihelion (closest point to the Sun).

Much further out, up to about 12 times more distant from the Sun than the Kuiper belt, *Sedna* is about a third the size of Pluto. It has a very eccentric orbit lasting about 12,000 years, and is now approaching perihelion. It is part of the Oort Cloud, the farthest belt in the solar system from which most comets originate.

There are three other known objects in the Kuiper Belt that are about 1/3 to 1/5 the size of Pluto: *Haumea*, *Quaoar* and *Makemake* (according to wikipedia). They all orbit the Sun at about Pluto's most distant point from the Sun. Together with Ceres, the largest spherical body in the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter, these largest minor planets (except so-far, Quaoar) are now called "dwarf planets" by most astronomers. Those beyond Neptune are called *plutoids*. Pluto also has about 200 "companions" called [Plutinos](#). They orbit the Sun at the same rate as Pluto, having the same relationship of 2 orbits for every 3 of Neptune. Thus they confirm the significance of the length of Pluto's orbit. Some of them also pass inside of Neptune, and some have orbits as eccentric and far-inclined as Pluto's. They are all no more than about 20 to 40 times smaller in mass than Pluto. The largest plutinos are named Orcus, Huya and Ixion.

Orcus has an orbit that compliments Pluto's. I don't know it's exact position yet. It may have made a conjunction to Neptune around 1760 (7 Years War), and does so once every 494 years. It's most recent opposition to Neptune may have been around 2007. It's latest conjunction to Uranus could have been around 1948-49 (Chinese Revolution?). It comes closest to Earth in early Pisces or sidereal Aquarius (it last did so around 1890, also the time of Neptune's conjunction to Pluto), and is approaching aphelion (farthest away) now.

Some of the centaurs like Chiron may have been former Kuiper Belt objects cast downward by Pluto's gravity pull, confirming Pluto's role as "lord of the underworld." There are a few other "resonances" (ratios) to Neptune followed by some Kuiper belt objects, but Pluto's 2 to 3 ratio is the most common and significant. Remember this is also a 1 to 3 resonance with Uranus at the same time. The majority of other Kuiper Belt Objects don't follow any orbital resonance with other planets. Discovery of all these objects may confirm what integral philosophers say: that the 1990s represent the beginning of the integral phase (or the early ascendancy of the holistic phase). But I date the integral meme from discovery of Chiron in 1977, first of the new bodies to be discovered after Pluto. By the later 1960s and early 1970s, when the green meme began to emerge, Pluto was coming into sharper focus as it approached its closest point to Earth, and we learned that Pluto was much smaller than first thought. After Pluto's moon Charon was discovered in 1978, the size of Pluto was confirmed, and it became clear that we had been seeing Pluto and Charon together in a larger fuzzy image. Perhaps that means, in the emerging "integral" meme since 1977-78, we are now seeing the green meme in a clearer perspective as well.

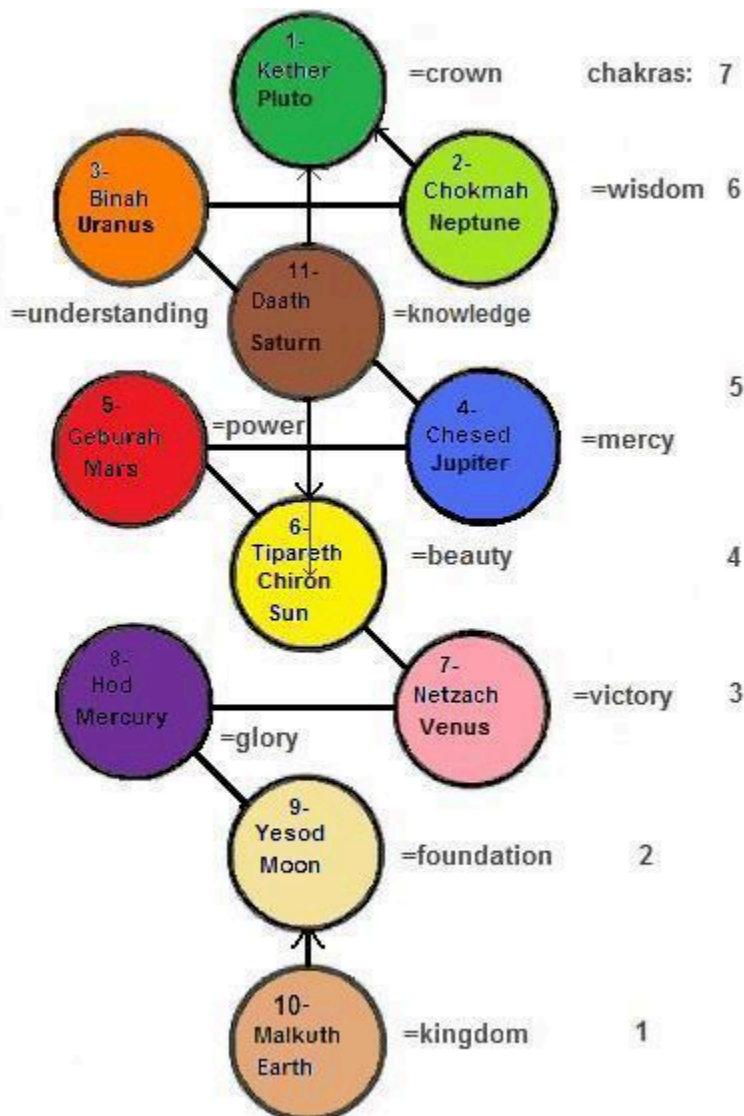
Since the planets are such potent symbols of different ways of thinking, feeling and behaving, and since so many of them seem to illustrate the memes of Spiral Dynamics, and in the same order, I decided to associate the planets with the stages or memes in Spiral Dynamics, and call it **Planetary Dynamics.**

The main point I am making is revealed by the obvious difference between Spiral Dynamics and Astrology. There are 7 memes, but 10 planets. In fact, **in looking at these 7 Spiral Dynamics stages, it seemed to me that three important historical stages were missing.** Besides the 7 chakras, another esoteric model came to mind here, and that is the [Kabbalah's Tree of Life](#), which has the same 7 levels like the chakras, but consists of 10 circles (the Sephiroth). There is also a shadowy 11th circle (Daath). In the Tree of Life symbol, there are two circles instead of one on three of the levels. I decided to lay out my revised version of Spiral Dynamics on the Tree of Life diagram instead of a straight spiral to represent the successive stages in human evolution and history.

The right side of the Tree is flowing and merciful (these are the yin phases, although traditionally called masculine), and the left side is intellectual and formal (yang phases, but traditionally considered feminine). These are also called the pillar of mercy on the right, and the pillar of severity of the left. The circles in the middle pillar represent integration and balance. Thus, the "communal" phases are the circles on the right, and the "individualist" phases are the circles on the left. The only difference from the spiral dynamic is that Mercury (tribal, magical, purple) is placed on the individualist, yang side. But this fits, since the "severe" or individualist side is also

considered intellectual, as is Mercury (and the purple meme's belief in animism or individual spirits also fits). The Integral yellow meme is placed in the balance column, which seems appropriate.

In this diagram I have colored the circles (or sephiroth) on the Kabbalah's Tree of Life to match the color of the memes in Spiral Dynamics, which are often different from the colors usually used on the Tree. Using the Tree of Life's 11 circles, I can add stages for the *agricultural, goddess* meme (Venus/pink), the *royal, scientific* meme (Saturn/brown), and the *romantic, socialist* meme (Neptune/lemon), as well as a stage for *human emergence* on the planet (Earth/tan) before the beige instinctive meme.



In another interesting twist, *modern occultists have ALSO associated the same planets with most of the same circles* on the Tree of Life, in an ascending pattern from the Earth and Moon at the bottom of the Tree to Saturn (and perhaps the outer invisible planets) at the top of the Tree.

This planetary "ladder" used by occultists on the Tree is geocentric, based on the ancient view of the cosmos, so that the Sun is in the middle of the ladder at the heart chakra. In fact, of course, this place of the Sun on the Tree of Life actually represents the Earth's position. I have used this central circle to represent the highest stage, the integral. Wherever Earth is placed on the Tree, you can also put the Sun, and vice versa; depending on whether you are looking at things geocentrically or heliocentrically. [Halexandria Foundation](#) shows a Tree of Life with the planets on it (scroll down on their website a bit to see their list). An example of a more-traditional interpretation of the Tree is by [BOTA](#) (but planets are indicated only by their glyphs).

Below is a table that shows how I associate the planets with the stages (read from bottom up). As I will explain later, I perceive that cultural history is more complicated than simply a progression of one stage following another. While one predominates, the next one is *rising* and starts to become apparent in each stage's later years. What's more, still another meme has recently been overthrown by the current one; now channeled and guided under the dominance of the new meme to unfold its highest qualities and potentials, which it couldn't do while it was busy dominating and controlling us. I use the astrological term *exalted* to represent this. Of course, each newly-dominant meme also carries some of the baggage or methods of domination given us by the previous meme that is now exalted. So in the table I show how history is shaped by the dominant planetary meme, as well as by the next one rising, and by the previous one, now exalted. In addition, as we said, older memes (especially recent ones) continue to be influential, in some ways, or especially in some "more backward" places and among some groups of people. It's later "exalted" expression may also continue.

After we discovered the revolutionary planets (beginning with Uranus in 1781), the process changed a bit, as things moved more quickly. And it's harder for people to keep up, too! As the leading revolutionary trend, the "dominant planetary meme" in modern and post-modern times does not fully rule society right away, and certainly not in all places on Earth; this may take a few years. Being *revolutionary* and "invisible" to ordinary minds, it faces resistance from Saturn, the "status quo."

Another advantage of Planetary Dynamics is that the succession of dates resemble more closely the Fibonacci Series, the basis of the spiral in Nature. This progression applies more easily to the last 4 stages if you use only two of the dates (1781, 1977), since these 4 stages are considered two sets of "twins" or "partners." In that sense, there are still only 8 stages. The progression from Venus to Mars around -2300 also mirrors the proposed shift in astrological ages at that time from Taurus to Aries (since in astrology, Venus rules Taurus and Mars rules Aries), and that from Mars to Jupiter around 300 dovetails with the change from Aries to Pisces (co-ruled by Jupiter). Perhaps the shift to Uranus in 1781 signals the dawn of the Age of Aquarius (ruled by Uranus), although Saturn had already prepared the way as co-ruler of Aquarius.

Begin date (approx.)	Planet	chakra & meme color	Sephiroth (#)	Meaning of	Planet Exalted Under	Planet in Ascendant

				Dominatin g Planet	Dominant (previous meme)	(next meme)
1977	Chiron, Sun/Earth	4-yellow	Tipareth (6)	Integral, regression and healing, keys to growth, personal high tech, nested hierarchy, "transcend and include" all previous worldview memes	Pluto- New Age and transformat ional movement s, the Green Party, recycling and alternative energies, consensus (Charon discovered 1978; Kuiper Belt disc. 1993)	Eris, discovered 2003-- holistic, connect to galaxy and cosmos
1966	Pluto	7-green	Kether (1)	Ecology and Peace, All One on Earth, Eco-femini sm, diversity or "fraternity," gestalt therapy etc., cultural creatives, information age, post-moder n times (Uranus conj. Pluto 1966)	Neptune- Sensitivity, psychedeli a, conscious ness movement, search for community, etc.	Chiron- integral. Chiron disc.1977, other centaurs disc. c.1993

1846	Neptune	6-lemon	Chokmah (2)	Socialism, collectivism, humanitarian, "equality," romanticism, transcendentalism, mysticism, modern arts, workers, unions, socialist power (conj. Pluto 1892), modern times	Uranus-People's and Utopian Activism, industrial revolution, inventions at peak, new physics, democracy advances; Saturn still "the status quo" (e.g. old science, law)	Pluto-psychology, existentialism, bio-energetics, conservation (conj. Neptune 1892, discovered 1930)
1781	Uranus	6-orange	Binah (3)	Democracy, Individualism, Inventions, Electricity, science of the invisible, middle class, "liberty," revolutions, early industry in Britain, idealism, proto-modern times	Saturn-constitutional law, atomic physics and chemistry	Neptune-socialism, romanticism
1300	Saturn	5-brown	Daath (11)	Kingdoms, Science of	Jupiter-revived	Uranus-individuals,

				the visible, secular state, dualism, perspective , aristocracy, early-modern times	neo-Platonism and modern philosophy, Exploration , The Reformation, "divine right" of kings	middle class and mercantile commerce
300	Jupiter	5-blue	Chesed (4)	Religious Rule, Church, moral laws, traditional or medieval times	Mars-chivalry, religious empires, feudalism	Saturn-state, law
-2300	Mars	5-red	Geburah (5)	Empires, war-gods, patriarchy begins, assertive self (glory and fame), metal-work , late archaic and classic age	Venus-classic visual art, commerce, the golden mean	Jupiter-religion, philosophy (Axis Age c. 500 BC)
-7000	Venus	3-pink	Netzach (7)	Agriculture, Goddess worship, fertility, towns, neolithic, archaic age	Mercury-writing, civilization	Mars- war, patriarchy, metal-work
-30,000	Mercury	3-purple	Hod (8)	Magical, tribal,	Moon-tribal	Venus-goddess

				animism, nomadic hunter-gath erer culture, old stone age, language	identity. Moon reflects the sun's rays= Sun worship.	worship, art, agriculture
-80,000	The Moon	2-beige	Yesod (9)	Instinct. Tool-makin g, early cultural objects	Earth-- first human societies	Mercury- magic, language
before -80,000	Earth	1-tan	Malkuth (10)	Human species <i>homo sapiens</i> developing	Sun: early humans	Moon: tools

not dismiss Pluto, even if some astronomers don't call it a planet anymore; we know that its significance has been demonstrated beyond all doubt. The largest object in the Kuiper Belt, Pluto is the primary link or way-station between planets and minor planets, the planets and beyond, or life and after-life.

♄ **Chiron**, discovered in 1977, was the first "minor planet" besides the asteroids to be discovered after Pluto. Pluto's Moon *Charon* was discovered a year later. This icy asteroid called Chiron moves between the orbits of Saturn and Uranus, and even beyond them. It thus has been given the traits of a "rainbow bridge" or "key" between the visible and invisible realms by astrologers. Its discovery happened when many keys and tools of transformation emerged, both ancient and modern, within the New Age and Human Potential movements, as well as to when personal high tech began (Apple Computer was founded in 1977). Chiron is also called the "wounded healer," representing wisdom gained through integrating and healing the wounds and chaotic conditions of life. Similar objects to Chiron have been discovered since 1992 in the same area; they are called *centaurs*, since in mythology Chiron was a centaur. Several of them, including Chariklo and Pholus, are now believed to be larger than Chiron. They may continue in these orbits for only 1 to 10 million years, having descended from beyond Neptune and Pluto, perturbed by their orbits; after which they may fall below Jupiter and become comets.

The controversial reduction in status of Pluto to a [dwarf planet](#) occurred around 2006, just when politics in America seemed in *full retreat* from all the advances of the 20th Century (and it still is). Perhaps all of Pluto's forbidden fruits were being put back in the closet or buried underground again, even as Pluto began its trek back into the depths from its nearest passage

to us in 1989. Thus everything from socialism, and its watered-down applications in America like the New Deal and the Great Society, to pluralism and tolerance of other religions, to restoring the environment, to releasing repressed and primitive energy, to spiritual awakening and cultural experiments, and above all the realizations of the peace movement, were all being denounced and destroyed by the Bush administration and the Republicans (and now even *more* clearly by Donald Trump). Even science was in retreat. Just as Pluto in its new lower status now has to fight for recognition, so do all the progressive advances of the 20th century.

On the other hand, all this regression, which had been building momentum since the late 1970s when Chiron and Charon were discovered, and launched in earnest by the ascension of the reactionary Ronald Reagan, might yet fulfill some purpose in the larger scheme of things. We can symbolize this with Chiron, since in effect it has put us back below Uranus again, with the aim of rediscovering some of the lost values of earlier memes. If one of these days, instead of just regressing and going back to them, as has been happening under Bush and the Republicans, we can *include and also transcend* these earlier stages, saving what is valuable and discarding the rest, then some healing of our nation and world could occur. Chiron "the wounded healer" centaur, and the other "centaurs," can thus symbolize the integration made possible by moving down from the transcendent memes in the invisible realms back into traditional memes in visible realms, while discovery of Eris and the Kuiper belt represents the "holistic" transcendent meme that is now in the ascendant.. Chiron also represents all the older ancient methods of esoteric knowledge, like astrology, the chakras, the kabbalah, and ancient mysticism and shamanism, now being rediscovered since at least the 1970s when Chiron was discovered.

The first object of the *Kuiper belt* after Pluto was discovered only in 1993. This Belt includes many objects similar to Pluto, all made of ice and rock, but smaller. About 1000 objects have been found in it so far. That could be very symbolic, since the internet started the same year (also the year of Uranus' conjunction to Neptune). The vast Kuiper Belt reminds us of the "cloud" of computers now connecting our planet into one cyber-mind. Though many of these objects have a similar composition to Pluto, there is also great "diversity."

Eris, discovered in 2003, has a very ecliptic and uncircular orbit that takes it far beyond the Kuiper belt, and then back again inside the farthest reaches of Pluto's orbit. Eris is about as large as Pluto by itself (recent information is that it isn't "larger" than Pluto). It's discovery was the occasion for Pluto's demotion from planethood. It is said by astrologers to be "quarrelsome," which would fit in with the crazy and unnecessary Iraq War launched by Bush in 2003. But does Eris have a higher meaning, just as Pluto once stood for the holocaust and nuclear weapons, but now represents peace and ecology? Eris takes about 560 years to orbit the Sun. Some other smaller objects have similar orbits to Eris, and others may be found. It could be that, just as Chiron's discovery represented the start of regression that brought us below Neptune again in our consciousness (the Reagan reaction and the potential "integration" of older memes), so Eris' discovery in 2003 might represent the renewed questioning of the Reagan-Bush regression after Hurricane Katrina and the War in Iraq, and our resumed quest to expand our collective consciousness upward again and connect with the galaxy. Eris is considered one of the

scattered disc objects, the next group beyond the Kuiper Belt, although like some others it also comes inside the Kuiper Belt toward its perihelion (closest point to the Sun).

Much further out, up to about 12 times more distant from the Sun than the Kuiper belt, *Sedna* is about a third the size of Pluto. It has a very eccentric orbit lasting about 12,000 years, and is now approaching perihelion. It is part of the Oort Cloud, the farthest belt in the solar system from which most comets originate.

There are three other known objects in the Kuiper Belt that are about 1/3 to 1/5 the size of Pluto: *Haumea*, *Quaoar* and *Makemake* (according to wikipedia). They all orbit the Sun at about Pluto's most distant point from the Sun. Together with Ceres, the largest spherical body in the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter, these largest minor planets (except so far, Quaoar) are now called "dwarf planets" by most astronomers. Those beyond Neptune are called *plutoids*. Pluto also has about 200 "companions" called *Plutinos*. They orbit the Sun at the same rate as Pluto, having the same relationship of 2 orbits for every 3 of Neptune. Thus they confirm the significance of the length of Pluto's orbit. Some of them also pass inside of Neptune, and some have orbits as eccentric and far-inclined as Pluto's. They are all no more than about 20 to 40 times smaller in mass than Pluto. The largest plutinos are named Orcus, Huya and Ixion.

Orcus has an orbit that compliments Pluto's. I don't know it's exact position yet. It may have made a conjunction to Neptune around 1760 (7 Years War), and does so once every 494 years. It's most recent opposition to Neptune may have been around 2007. It's latest conjunction to Uranus could have been around 1948-49 (Chinese Revolution?). It comes closest to Earth in early Pisces or sidereal Aquarius (it last did so around 1890, also the time of Neptune's conjunction to Pluto), and is approaching aphelion (farthest away) now.

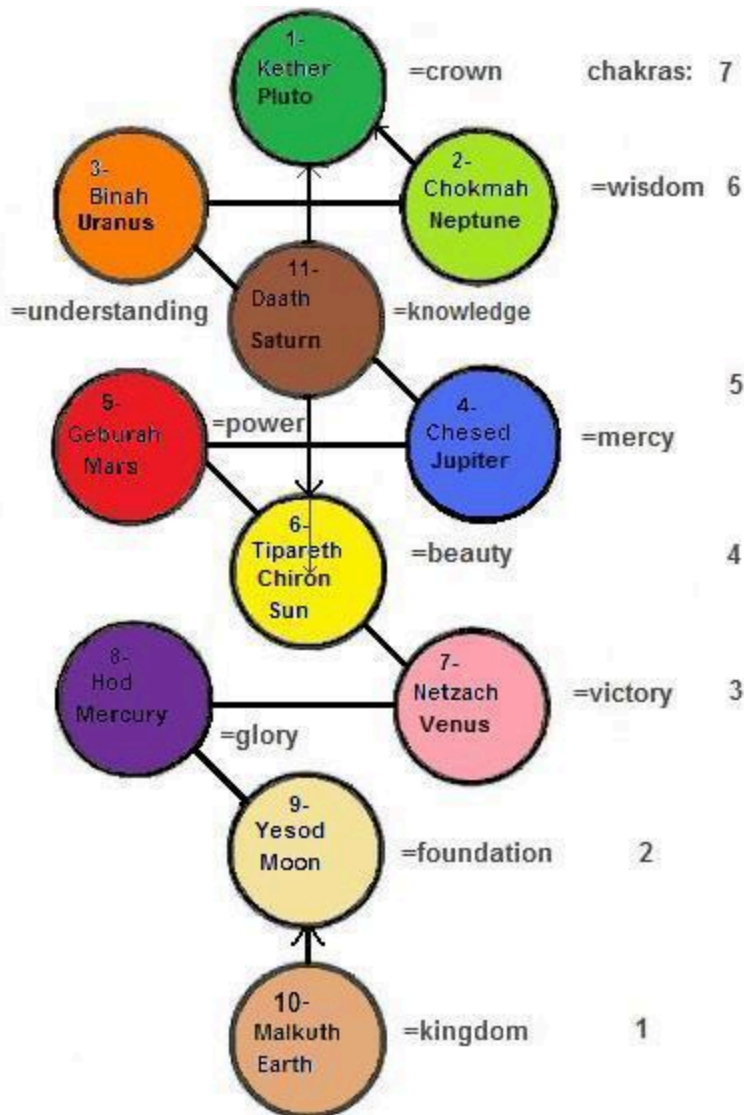
Some of the centaurs like Chiron may have been former Kuiper Belt objects cast downward by Pluto's gravity pull, confirming Pluto's role as "lord of the underworld." There are a few other "resonances" (ratios) to Neptune followed by some Kuiper belt objects, but Pluto's 2 to 3 ratio is the most common and significant. Remember this is also a 1 to 3 resonance with Uranus at the same time. The majority of other Kuiper Belt Objects don't follow any orbital resonance with other planets. Discovery of all these objects may confirm what integral philosophers say: that the 1990s represent the beginning of the integral phase (or the early ascendancy of the holistic phase). But I date the integral meme from discovery of Chiron in 1977, first of the new bodies to be discovered after Pluto. By the later 1960s and early 1970s, when the green meme began to emerge, Pluto was coming into sharper focus as it approached its closest point to Earth, and we learned that Pluto was much smaller than first thought. After Pluto's moon Charon was discovered in 1978, the size of Pluto was confirmed, and it became clear that we had been seeing Pluto and Charon together in a larger fuzzy image. Perhaps that means, in the emerging "integral" meme since 1977-78, we are now seeing the green meme in a clearer perspective as well.

Since the planets are such potent symbols of different ways of thinking, feeling and behaving, and since so many of them seem to illustrate the memes of Spiral Dynamics, and in the same order, I decided to associate the planets with the stages or memes in Spiral Dynamics, and call it **Planetary Dynamics**.

The main point I am making is revealed by the obvious difference between Spiral Dynamics and Astrology. There are 7 memes, but 10 planets. In fact, **in looking at these 7 Spiral Dynamics stages, it seemed to me that three important historical stages were missing**. Besides the 7 chakras, another esoteric model came to mind here, and that is the [Kabbalah's Tree of Life](#), which has the same 7 levels like the chakras, but consists of 10 circles (the Sephiroth). There is also a shadowy 11th circle (Daath). In the Tree of Life symbol, there are two circles instead of one on three of the levels. I decided to lay out my revised version of Spiral Dynamics on the Tree of Life diagram instead of a straight spiral to represent the successive stages in human evolution and history.

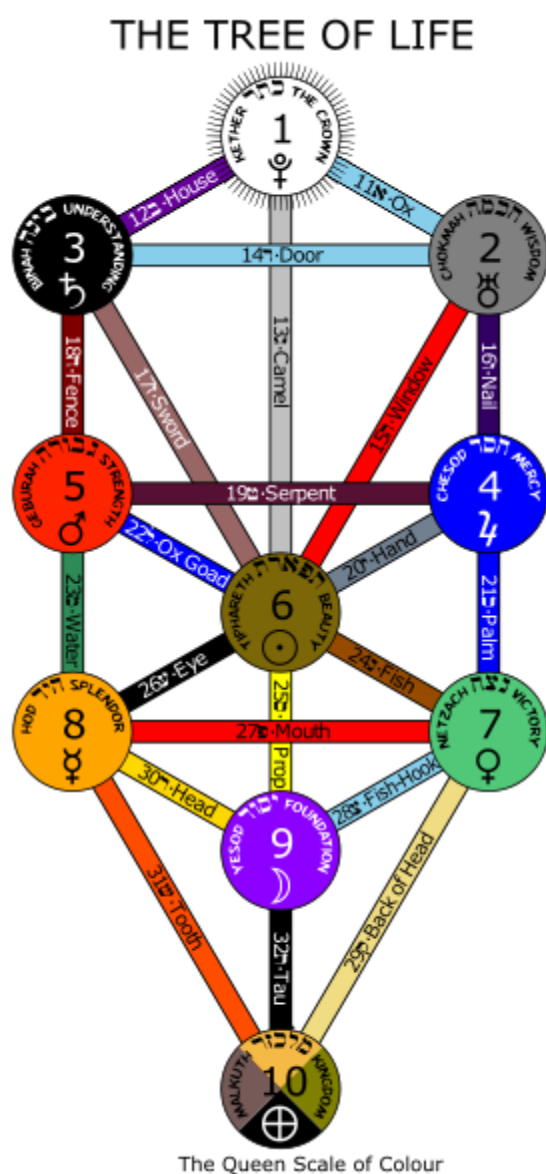
The right side of the Tree is flowing and merciful (these are the yin phases, although traditionally called masculine), and the left side is intellectual and formal (yang phases, but traditionally considered feminine). These are also called the pillar of mercy on the right, and the pillar of severity of the left. The circles in the middle pillar represent integration and balance. Thus, the "communal" phases are the circles on the right, and the "individualist" phases are the circles on the left. The only difference from the spiral dynamic is that Mercury (tribal, magical, purple) is placed on the individualist, yang side. But this fits, since the "severe" or individualist side is also considered intellectual, as is Mercury (and the purple meme's belief in animism or individual spirits also fits). The Integral yellow meme is placed in the balance column, which seems appropriate.

In this diagram I have colored the circles (or sephiroth) on the Kabbalah's Tree of Life to match the color of the memes in Spiral Dynamics, which are often different from the colors usually used on the Tree. Using the Tree of Life's 11 circles, I can add stages for the *agricultural, goddess* meme (Venus/pink), the *royal, scientific* meme (Saturn/brown), and the *romantic, socialist* meme (Neptune/lemon), as well as a stage for *human emergence* on the planet (Earth/tan) before the beige instinctive meme.



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Here is an image of the Tree of Life with the symbols for the planets indicated (note how the positions of the 3 outer planets differ from both the above article, and from my Tree):



Below is a table that shows how I associate the planets with the stages (read from bottom up). As I will explain later, I perceive that cultural history is more complicated than simply a progression of one stage following another. While one predominates, the next one is *rising* and starts to become apparent in each stage's later years. What's more, still another meme has recently been overthrown by the current one; now channeled and guided under the dominance of the new meme to unfold its highest qualities and potentials, which it couldn't do while it was busy dominating and controlling us. I use the astrological term *exalted* to represent this. Of course, each newly-dominant meme also carries some of the baggage or methods of domination given us by the previous meme that is now exalted. So in the table I show how

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				worldview memes	discovered 1978; Kuiper Belt disc. 1993)	
1966	Pluto	7-green	Kether (1)	Ecology and Peace, All One on Earth, Eco-femini sm, diversity or "fraternity," gestalt therapy etc., cultural creatives, information age, post-modern times (Uranus conj. Pluto 1966)	Neptune- Sensitivity, psychedeli a, consciousness movement, search for community, etc.	Chiron- integral. Chiron disc.1977, other centaurs disc. c.1993
1846	Neptune	6-lemon	Chokmah (2)	Socialism, collectivism , humanitarian, "equality," romanticism, transcendentalism, mysticism, modern arts, workers, unions, socialist power (conj. Pluto	Uranus- People's and Utopian Activism, industrial revolution, inventions at peak, new physics, democracy advances; Saturn still "the status quo" (e.g. old	Pluto- psychology , existentialism, bio-energetics, conservation (conj. Neptune 1892, discovered 1930)

				1892), modern times	science, law)	
1781	Uranus	6-orange	Binah (3)	Democracy , Individualis m, Inventions, Electricity, science of the invisible, middle class, "liberty," revolutions, early industry in Britain, idealism, proto-mode rn times	Saturn- constitution al law, atomic physics and chemistry	Neptune- socialism, romanticis m
1300	Saturn	5-brown	Daath (11)	Kingdoms, Science of the visible, secular state, dualism, perspective , aristocracy, early-mode rn times	Jupiter- revived neo-Platoni c and modern philosophy, Exploration , The Reformatio n, "divine right" of kings	Uranus- individuals, middle class and mercantile commerce
300	Jupiter	5-blue	Chesed (4)	Religious Rule, Church, moral laws, traditional or	Mars- chivalry, religious empires, feudalism	Saturn- state, law

				medieval times		
-2300	Mars	5-red	Geburah (5)	Empires, war-gods, patriarchy begins, assertive self (glory and fame), metal-work , late archaic and classic age	Venus-classic visual art, commerce, the golden mean	Jupiter-religion, philosophy (Axis Age c. 500 BC)
-7000	Venus	3-pink	Netzach (7)	Agriculture, Goddess worship, fertility, towns, neolithic, archaic age	Mercury-writing, civilization	Mars- war, patriarchy, metal-work
-30,000	Mercury	3-purple	Hod (8)	Magical, tribal, animism, nomadic hunter-gatherer culture, old stone age, language	Moon-tribal identity. Moon reflects the sun's rays= Sun worship.	Venus-goddess worship, art, agriculture
-80,000	The Moon	2-beige	Yesod (9)	Instinct. Tool-making, early cultural objects	Earth-- first human societies	Mercury-magic, language
before -80,000	Earth	1-tan	Malkuth (10)	Human species <i>homo</i>	Sun: early humans	Moon: tools

				sapiens developing		
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Tan, before -80,000: The Earth represents our home on which the **human species** began to emerge. The **Moon was rising**, representing invention of tools by these emerging humans. This phase represents humans that existed before our own particular line or subspecies came on the scene around -80,000 or -75,000, in South Africa, after most humans were wiped out by a climate change probably caused by a volcanic eruption in Indonesia. Even earlier was the first phase, before -250,000, that can be indicated by *The Sun, now exalted* in the Earth/Tan phase, which represents the first humans, going back millions of years.



Beige, -80,000 to -30,000: The Moon is instinct and nurturing. This represents **advances in tool-making, and the incubation of humanity** in

which we acquired our basic traits as humans, including the first culture, crafts, etc. Our line of descent began settling from Southern Africa to the rest of the world (*Earth exalted*) and separating into different races (Moon represents ancestry, racial identities). **Mercury is in the ascendant**, meaning that tribal culture and language are developing, especially in the later years of the era.



Purple, -30,000 to -7000: Mercury is knowledge, language, communication, travel, magic, and association with brethren, relatives, etc. This was the phase of **nomadic hunter-gatherer tribes**, cave paintings and the invention of magic through evoking the spirit of natural forces (animism = belief that each being in nature has a spirit), and influencing events with the mind. Verbal language may have fully developed in this period, as the people enacted rituals and told stories and myths of their ancestors around the campfire. *The Moon was exalted*, representing the expansion of family awareness into tribes. **Venus rising** represents the first early art in the cave paintings and in goddess sculptures, and agriculture is on the horizon or first emerging in the last years of the period.



Pink, -7000 to -2300: Venus is the planet of love, beauty, values, commerce, the goddess and the fertility of Nature. This was the age when **agriculture** was invented and became dominant in human society. Settled life, hierarchy, division of labor, and regional trade emerged in a comparatively peaceful era. The goddess was worshipped everywhere, and the arts blossomed in the first architecture and sculpture, such as the pyramids, ziggurats and stone circles. These arts celebrated the spirituality and relationship of the Earth and Sky, the cycles of life and death, and the fertility Goddess. It was in this period that animal (and sometimes human) sacrifice was used to insure that this fertility would continue. This period is also called the new stone age (neolithic). *Mercury was exalted*, as the

early knowledge of tribal magic developed into the first writing, inventions, astrology, and the other arts of civilization. The arrival of civilized life as we know it, circa -3000 can also be indicated by passing through the central circle (Earth) on the way to the Mars meme. **Mars rising** represents the first warfare and the emerging patriarchy and bronze-work in the later years of the era.



Red, -2300 to 300: Mars is the planet of war, conquest and male dominance. Beginning with Sargon, this was the **age of war** conducted by powerful emperors. Warrior chiefs, inspired by war-gods, conquered and ruled cities and vast territories in a series of ever more-powerful empires until they were all brought under one universal empire (Rome, or China in the Orient). Although the emperors issued edicts, these were not states in the modern sense, in which peoples shared an identity, language and law and lived within fairly-stable boundaries. This Martian kind of "state" was really just the boundaries of the latest conquest. Martian assertive individualism expressed itself in the first democratic experiments in the early classic age (c.500-100 BC), and the quest for personal fame and glory. The wars redistributed the wealth and opened trade routes, breaking through the old hierarchies of the age of agriculture. Patriarchal gods replaced worship of the goddess everywhere, brought by warrior races who swooped in to conquer existing agricultural civilizations and settlements. Mars also represents iron and the skill to conquer nature by working with metals, as the stone age yielded to that of bronze and iron. *Venus was exalted* in the era of classical arts (especially after -570), which was pursued within the new aggressive empires and warring city states. Ancient Greece created the first great dramas, and the Parthenon with its magnificent sculpture-- even as its leader Pericles led his people into constant wars. Egypt in the New Kingdom circa -1500-1100 became a warrior empire which conquered territory outside its usual bounds, but at the same time created its most magnificent temples such as those at Carnak and the Valley of Kings. Since conquerers use strategy to rule and administer territory, the Mars meme is also rational. People demonstrated these rational abilities in great feats of engineering like the aqueducts, especially in Greece and Rome. **Jupiter rising** represents the dawn of religion and philosophy which arose to guide and restrain these ambitious warriors, especially in Israel, and also in ancient Greece in the later stages of the era after -570. Jupiter and its religions had not yet reached the stage of worldly power, but its prophets and philosophers issued advice and warnings to the often-heedless warrior kings and emperors. And in the Orient, as well as in Egypt and among early Roman neo-Platonists, the rising Jupiter indicated the first mystic consciousness, which became the "perennial philosophy" available to a few initiates.



Blue, 300 to 1300: Jupiter represents the Church, philosophy, world travel and moral guidance. It is pomp, ritual, faith, and organized religion. This was the age of **rule by the Church**, as the Martian empires became Jovian religious ones. The Church and priesthood became dominant in society, especially in the Christian Roman Empire and its successors, and in the Islamic Empire. Here the emperor was also the chief priest (Caesaro-papism). Religious and moral law became imperial law in 300 under Constantine, and later the Popes *also* became emperors. Meanwhile Charlemagne was crowned by the Pope in 800, and in 962 the Holy Roman Empire was established in Germany and Italy. Priests later became known as *the first estate*, the highest class in society, as bishops and powerful monastic orders extended their rule over the land. Organized religion and its cults and myths in the Age of Faith gave inspiration, confidence, prophetic hope and moral guidance to the people, and later became visible in great cathedrals, but also sometimes repressed or discouraged science and freedom of thought. Classical culture declined in the Dark Ages, often wiped out by massive migration and barbaric invasions, especially in the early years of the Jupiter/religious era. But as society gradually settled down, feudalism, hierarchy and ceremonial ritual kept people in their place in the social order. The code of chivalry represents *Mars in its exalted expression*, as warriors now had rules to live by, just as did the religious emperors. Although the Church was dominant, and the Pope was the first among rulers, **Saturn was in the ascendant**; as feudal dynasties emerged and small kingdoms expanded. The power of the state was on the horizon, and it competed with the Church for power in the later years of the era.



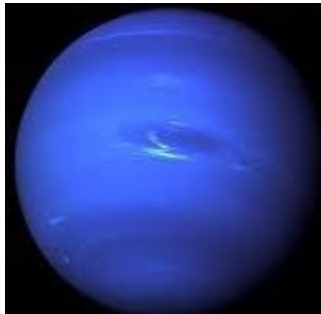
Brown, 1300 to 1781: Saturn, symbol of worldly structure, order and restriction, represents the **age of kings and the power of the state and landed aristocracy**, the second estate. Like during the Venus era, which I have also added to the spiral dynamic scheme, the powers-that-be depended on their control of the land and its fertility; and both eras were very hierarchical and stratified. Around 1300 powerful kings like Philip the Fair and Edward I became near-absolute rulers and asserted their domination over the Church. The Pope's exile in Avignon under Philip is the most eloquent symbol of the state's ascension. Powerful hereditary, dynastic kings became great powers: Spain, England, France, Russia, etc. Unlike the old empires, these kings ruled over states with more-stable territories often populated by people with a developing common culture and language. The kings made the law and held the

allegiance of the people, and their power was on display in elegant palaces. Just as kings, guided by law and sanctioned by God, ruled over the people and the land, so emerging **science** (Roger Bacon, William of Occam, c.1300) gave birth to the new technology which ruled over visible Nature so that people could use it for their own ends. Seeing was believing. The artists of the Renaissance invented perspective (1420), giving us a humanist, structured view of the world as a landscape over which we could travel and conquer. They also inspired the world explorers and conquerers (Columbus, 1492), which led to advances in navigation, astronomy and physics (Copernicus c.1540, Galileo c.1600, Newton c.1680) in the scientific revolution. The new science (e.g. Descartes, 1637) split the world into the human spirit dominating an alien physical world, which empowered it to throw off the restraints of religion. Confrontation with reality (e.g. the black plague, 1348), and the subsequent questioning of Faith in the increasingly-secular age of kings, was reflected in the tragedies of Shakespeare (1600). Meanwhile *Jupiter was exalted* beyond religious dogma into a revival of philosophy (Renaissance neo-platonism and humanism), as well as in the spread of civilization and religion around the globe (Jupiter means wide travel and exploration) through colonization by the kings and explorers. The Reformation purified the practices and doctrines of the Christian Church. As commerce expanded, the bourgeois middle class merchants, accountants, and mercantile powers were in the ascendant (**Uranus rising**), and individual consciousness was rising (Renaissance inspired seekers of fame and fortune). The scientific revolution encouraged increasing questioning of authority in politics as well as in religion, at least in the later years of the era.



Orange, 1781 to 1846: Uranus, symbol of invention and revolution, represents the age of **democratic revolution** (Uranus discovered, 1781). Inspired in part by the Americans, who achieved independence from Britain in 1781, the French in their Revolution overthrew their kings and aristocracy (1789-92) and formed a nation ruled by its people. Patriotism was established. Then the new "emperor" Napoleon spread democratic law codes throughout Europe. Much like what happened during the earlier yang Mars era, the revolutions of Uranus broke through class hierarchies and spread the wealth around. The industrial revolution "took off" in 1781, especially in England, as the Middle Class (the third estate) became dominant and aristocratic barriers to commerce were increasingly removed (feudalism dissolved, 1789; corn laws finally repealed, 1846). Adam Smith described the wealth of nations based on *laissez-faire* (free enterprise). Inventions and discoveries suddenly opened invisible realms to our knowledge, corresponding to Uranus as the first planet discovered that is normally invisible to the naked eye (ultra-violet light, electricity and batteries discovered c.1780; magnetic generators, railroads c. 1830). Going beyond the visible also expressed itself in transcendental idealist philosophy (Kant, 1781, Hegel 1807), showing that the Uranus meme is not just a science meme, like the orange achievement meme of Spiral Dynamics. In fact, science under

Uranus was actually *breaking down* Saturnian structures in thought as well as in politics in the 19th century, eventually leading to modern physics that explains the invisible realms. Uranus also opened the age of the romantic rebel, in all its many aspects, along with its partner Neptune that came along shortly. But the true original symbol of empirical, physical science of the visible, and also of the secular state, *Saturn*, became exalted in this era, as scientific discovery advanced into the *invisible*. At the same time, royal edicts and common law became codified in the first *constitutions* that established justice and balance of power. With Saturn exalted, *the state* became (potentially at least) a *protector of human rights* (Bill of Rights, 1791; Rights of Man and Citizen, 1789), as well as continuing to be an instrument of wealthy and powerful elites. Meanwhile already in the French Revolution (Robespierre, 1793, Babeuf, 1796) workers and peasants began demanding freedom from wealthy bourgeois industrial bosses (**Neptune rising**). By the end of the era new socialist utopias were being dreamed, proposed and experimented with. The neo-classic art and music of the Uranus era (gallant style) gradually expanded into romanticism, including the worship of Nature and the quest of the exotic (Wordsworth, 1798, Beethoven 9th Symphony 1823).



Lemon, 1846 to 1966: Neptune, symbol of collective consciousness and power, dissolving boundaries, and mystical vision (Neptune discovered, 1846), represents the **age of socialism**. Industry expanded to many nations and people migrated across the globe. New Thought religions and new mystic philosophies emerged (spiritualism, 1850s; theosophy, 1890s). Neptune can be considered Uranus' partner-- two shorter phases on the same 6th level on the "Tree of Life" of planetary dynamics-- thus often ruling together. But after 1846, the Neptune meme gained power; attaining dominance by the 1890s and 1900s (Neptune conj. Pluto c.1892). By then, free enterprise/democracy (Uranus) and socialism and the welfare state (Neptune) were the ideologies of our political parties, and later competed for world power in the Cold War (Neptune square Uranus, 1950s). Neptune represents rising working class power, which I call the fourth estate (Communist Manifesto, 1848; labor unions, socialist parties achieve power in 1890s-1900s), but also increasing identification of peoples with their race (nationalism, racism, fascism, Nazis, KKK, civil rights movement, etc.), and in general *submersion* or sacrifice of the individual into the mass collective society. Humanitarian activism became part of our culture (Florence Nightengale, Clara Barton). Romantic art and music expanded into rich and lush sights and sounds, and transcendentalism, nature worship reached a high expression (Emerson, Thoreau, Ruskin, c.1840s-50s). *Uranus was exalted* in this era, as democracy expanded and revolutionaries became the voice of the common people, not just the middle class. Not only did industry become global, instead of confined to England, but inventions reached a peak (c.1880s-1910s) and the benefits of technology were extended to all. Science entered a new revolution, as the discoveries of the Uranus era (light, electricity) opened

up the domain of modern physics, which is leading gradually to a new science compatible with mysticism; although scientific materialism still predominates (Saturn still powerful as "the status quo"). Meanwhile, as socialist group-culture and industry alienated people from Nature in a dis-enchanted world, *mailaise* grew, and soul-searching began among lonely individual seekers within the mass of humanity (**Pluto rising**). Out of this came depth psychology, existentialism and modern art in the later years of the Neptune era (starting with Neptune conj. Pluto, 1890s). The holocaust of the world wars and nuclear weapons demonstrated the ultimate futility of war and nationalist racism (Pluto discovered, 1930).



Green, 1966-: That brings us to our own era, the age of **Pluto**(conjunct Uranus, 1966; Charon discovered 1978). I date the Pluto era later than its discovery in 1930, because it was not until the 1960s and 70s that we began to fully see Pluto's physical characteristics. For the first time, in this Pluto era, a great peace movement eventually stopped a major war conducted by the world's most-powerful state (American-Vietnam War 1965-1975). From now on, war is increasingly seen as out of date, partly because of the danger to all life posed by nuclear weapons (said by astrologers to be linked to Pluto), but also because **we know through our common peril that we are all one people on one common Earth**. This means respect for diversity instead of domination. Pluto represents life and death choices. Being now conscious as never before of the growing power of humans to end all life on Earth (Earth Day, 1970), green ideas have become a growing power in society, and recycling and sustainable energy are now top priorities. The greenpeace movement and environmentalism is beginning to dominate both politics and economics in the Pluto era, and the Green Party is a new force (Green Party in governing coalitions in Europe in 1980s; Nader spoiled US elections, 2000). Like the other revolutionary memes, Uranus/democracy and Neptune/socialism, it will take time for the Pluto Green meme to be fully dominant politically (Uranus opposite Pluto, late 2040s). Global warming is already requiring advanced post-industrial states to implement new energy policies (Carter, USA 1977, China/Europe, 2000s). Meanwhile the women's movement and eco-feminism is displacing patriarchal power in economics and politics. Absolutes are denied in post-modern times.

It is important to emphasize that Green politics is not just an extension of communitarian socialism (Lemon); its values bring back democratic reform, local economics and smaller institutions. While proclaiming that we are all one people on one planet, it also synthesizes the two previous revolutions, the individual and the collective, and thus is *proto-integral* (**Chiron rising**). It reclaims the value of the person from the runaway dehumanizing forces of the industrial era. Meanwhile cultural creatives and New Age movements reveal the Spirit to the lonely existential seekers of the previous era (represented by Pluto rising during the Neptune era), as the world is being gradually re-enchanted and religions of Nature are being revived. Science and mysticism are being combined into a "new paradigm" beyond mechanist thought.

The counterculture (LSD, 1966) spread this new awakening through psychedelics (*Neptune exalted*), and the new ambient music expands romanticism. Consciousness of world unity now transcends boundaries of race, nation, religion and gender ("Imagine" by John Lennon, 1971; "We Are the World," 1984; world prayer, 1986; harmonic convergence, 1987). Mysticism and the perennial philosophy have revived again since the 1960s among people in the West, since Neptune is now exalted under Pluto.



Yellow, **1977**:- Just as Pluto represents all these new trends emerging since the 1960s, its historical partner **Chiron**, the first of the many similar Centaurs to be discovered orbiting between Jupiter and Neptune, has added new dimensions to them. The Chiron or Yellow meme emphasizes the trend toward *integral consciousness* begun under the Green meme, and is its partner. The new mysticism (Neptune exalted in Pluto era) thus has become not only about oneness, but about individual holographic wholes within wholes. Just when Chiron was discovered in 1977, information technology put new creative and political power in peoples' hands (first video games; apple computer founded 1977). 1977 is coincidentally the date of the first publication of a book by integral philosopher [Ken Wilber](#). Practical techniques of personal growth, holistic health and spiritual healing have developed in the burgeoning New Age Movement (it acquired this name and identity around 1977). The Green Party was founded at about this same time, giving the green movements of the 1960s a specific political platform. The small rocky comet-asteroid Chiron's symbol of The Key shows that its position and movement between the visible and invisible planets, along with that of the other centaurs, provides its significance for us. They indicate new tools to help us access these higher outer-planet realms of power and inspiration, and at the same time help us and remind us to manifest this in our world and to integrate this new vision with the past cultures from which we have emerged. Our normal time routines and our usual ways may be pierced at times by the Centaurs so that we may make adjustments between the old and the new, and between the physical and the spiritual.

Pluto is exalted in the yellow Chiron meme. Notice again that Pluto's moon *Charon* was discovered at the same time as Chiron. In effect then, the *updated version of the Green meme*, is now also part of the integral meme. As Pluto's Moon was discovered, so was its intense, mutual gravitationally-locked *interrelationship* to Pluto. Thus Pluto became an eloquent symbol of *synthesis and interdependence, like the idea of ecology itself*. Both Chiron and Pluto-Charon are also symbols of the emerging *information age*. Integrated circuits, invented in the mid-1960s (date of the Pluto meme's ascendancy), got ever-smaller and yet *more powerful* in subsequent

years as personal computers and devices were developed, just as Pluto got smaller in our perception and new smaller objects were discovered. Small is beautiful, it appears; and more-powerful too! Dual planet Pluto-Charon became the symbol of binary systems, the basis of all computer language and circuitry. The crowning "cloud" of the Kuiper Belt became a symbol of the world wide web, invented in the year of the Belt's discovery.

At the same time, the new Green movements sparked a backlash, which as of 2017 has held politics in a regressive stalemate for decades (Margaret Thatcher in Britain 1979, Ronald Reagan elected US president 1980; Contract with America 1994, Tea Party 2010, Donald Trump 2016), taking us backward to earlier memes (like Saturn's materialism, and perhaps especially a false version of the Orange free-market, [individualist meme](#)), which in fact institutes an oppressive Saturnian corporate oligarchy. Regression to Jupiter represents the rise of the fundamentalist religious right and jihadist Islamic terrorism since 1978-79, while Mars represents the new imperialism under George W. Bush in 2003 (Project for a New American Century), and the ethnic strife and psychologically-regressed male aggression personified by Donald Trump (2017). Such regression may be unprecedented. Some also ask whether the New Age and sixties-style culture might regress us back to "pre-rational" stages that hook us on fantasy, instead of advancing us to higher non-rational ones.

Could all this regression have a larger purpose? As we become disillusioned with "progress" under the 3 outer modern invisible planets that disenchant and pollute the world, and destroys the individual, perhaps we can "regress" to reclaim and integrate for the first time the best of *all* the values from all preceeding "memes" in planetary/spiral dynamics, once we have healed ourselves from their worst aspects being released and revealed to us today. The polarized pair of Pluto-Charon may represent the increasing polarization of politics, as the Reagan-Gingrich-Religious Right backlash unfolded. The new integral or Chiron meme also reminds those of us influenced by the All One People Pluto/Green/post-modern meme that all people and all things are not *entirely* equal, and that we value excellence and quality. As our perspective widens, perhaps *a theory of everything*, in culture and society as well as in physics, is emerging today under Pluto/Charon, Chiron, and their many Kuiper belt and centaur companions discovered since the 1990s. The solar system is larger and more diverse than we thought, and so is life and the universe. This may also indicate our age of space exploration and increasing alien visitations (**Eris rising**).



I put the *yellow* Chiron/centaur stage down below Pluto on the Tree, on the path from Kether down to the central circle, to represent the fact that in many ways it is taking us below Neptune (socialism, etc.) again. The "temporary" status of Chiron and the centaurs, cast downward from the Kuiper belt by Neptune and Pluto, may represent the transitory nature of these regressive movements that began when Chiron ("the wounded healer") was discovered in 1977, or it may indicate the periodic need to take the "downward" current as well as the upward one on the planetary ladder, in order to find integration and healing. When this integration is finally found, it is represented by **The Sun** (and its color yellow), traditionally placed at the heart chakra in Tipareth by kabbalists, and this is also The Earth. With the discovery of Chiron, we began the journey to integration; the Sun represents a future time when we achieve it. *Turquoise* then represents a future "holistic" stage (Eris) when we can move forward again up to Kether and beyond. The vast new discoveries in the Kuiper belt (starting with Pluto in 1930) and of the centaurs (beginning with Chiron in 1977) is a momentous opportunity to *connect our mind (at the top of the Tree) and heart (at the center)* in a new higher consciousness guiding us from above, both as individuals and as a new planetary civilization. We are developing this heart/spirit connection, represented by the line with arrows connecting the heart and crown chakras in our new planetary Tree of Life diagram above.

This line goes both ways, just like Spiral Dynamics and the *chakra currents*. The centaurs are moving us inward toward the Earth and the Sun at the heart chakra, and the outer objects beyond Neptune are leading us outward toward the heart of the galaxy. This shows how in our new integral/holistic paradigm, we are learning to go inward and outward at once. We are learning that we effect the cosmos, as fully as it affects us. As Alan Watts said, "the whole universe depends on you, as much as you depend on it." Pluto and its Moon Charon, in their tight interrelationship, also represent *interdependence*. Pluto/Charon is meditation and inner spiritual power, in which active and passive/individual and whole blend as one; just as Pluto acts upon Charon, yet also is acted upon *by* Charon, and vice-versa. This is why Pluto-Charon also represents *ecology*, a link which was realized by this author 6 years before Charon was discovered, and one year after the first Earth Day.

Pluto-Charon may be the most significant planet *of any size* in our solar system. It truly merits its place at the top of the Tree of Life. Although there are other *dual or binary planets* in the Kuiper Belt, I have as yet heard of none with so close a relationship as Pluto/Charon, and in any case, none will likely be found close to Pluto in size or more significant than Pluto in its orbit. What are

the chances that such a tightly-dual planet could even exist? As well as ecology, it represents synchronicity and synthesis-- and also all the new findings in physics. The most amazing aspect of quantum theory, for example, is the fact that quanta are connected no matter how distant and out-of-contact they are. This connection at a "spooky distance" between spinning quanta is called *entanglement*, which Pluto and Charon exemplify by their completely-entangled connection to each other (though not literally, since their "entanglement" is caused by gravity, not quantum mechanics). Quantum theory, developed just as Pluto was discovered around 1930, came into sharper focus when this Bell Theorem was developed in the 1960s. These were signs of the emerging Green meme, and its nature as inter-relationship. A year or two after 1977, String Theory (begun in the late 1960s) came together and became popular, reducing quantum "particles" into massless "strands" of energy resonating like music. These strings are conceived, in among other ways, as shifting back and forth and turning around, just as if they were very-miniature spirals or chakra currents. Spiral galaxies, spiral chakras, and spiral strings; *as above, so below*.

Some people would rather not crown "tiny" Pluto at the top of the Tree of Life, preferring to tie it instead to shadowy Daath. But the outer 3 invisible planets Uranus, Neptune and Pluto remain a *transcendental trinity*, just like the Mind and "personhood" of God represented by the highest 3 circles on the Tree. Just as the whole universe started from a concentrated point, size doesn't count where the symbol of the source of creation (Kether) is concerned. And the power of Pluto is made crystal clear by how it dispenses the [fortunes of civilization](#), dealing life and death to great empires and armies on Earth as it moves in its great cycles, as well as sending centaurs down toward the Earth on a journey from the depths. Pluto, with its concentrated, synthetic, entangled, constant relationship to its moon Charon that gives it such concentrated power and focus, truly *is* the Lord of the outer solar system. Therefore I put Pluto on the Tree in accordance with the natural planetary progression upward and outward, on top of the Tree at Kether (which means crown), *just where it should be!* The entire Kuiper Belt is also indicated by Pluto's place on the Tree, and it also represents the great "diversity" of the green meme of All One People. It is a great symbol of a "crown" that surrounds and encircles the edge of the solar system. Interestingly, according to wikipedia, "The guidelines established by the IAU demand that classical KBOs be given names of mythological beings associated with creation." Similarly, wherever *Chiron* is shown, representing the discovery of the Integral yellow meme, *all the centaurs* are indicated too. **The Sun** itself is the symbol of full integration which we find within our own hearts, and it is *also* connected to the crown chakra.

The small planets that extend *beyond* the Kuiper Belt crown, including Eris, are represented by the "pre-Tree, indescribable" circles said to lie above the Tree, representing the holistic meme now rising which potentially connects us with the spirit throughout the greater cosmos. Philip Brown in his [article on Eris](#) writes that Eris may represent "the uninvited (by patriarchal culture) true strength and power of women," and "wholeness, the self, and creativity", among other things. Eris moves far outside the plane of the other planets, and far beyond the Kuiper Belt, suggesting that it can connect us with what is outside, uninvited, and far away. Now that we know all the planets, allowing us to get all of our chakras and planets working together, we may be ready to join a *larger* evolution already going on among the ETs in our galaxy, whose stages are represented by much greater symbol

Some notes on the planetary dynamic stages, and how they match the sephiroth and planets on the Tree of Life:

Earth, our home and center (tan) = **Malkuth**, which represents the Earth on the Tree; the place where we reside; the greater Self or Kingdom from which we arise.

Moon, the nurturer (beige) = **Yesod**, symbol of the Garden of Eden that nurtures life, as well as instinct and dreams in the subconscious, matching the instinctive phase in Spiral Dynamics.

Mercury, the messenger (purple) = **Hod**, symbol of magic and thought, representing that tribal age of magic when myths, language and symbols arose.

Venus, goddess of beauty and love (pink) = **Netzach**, symbol of endurance (agriculture), and of the emotional attraction of the senses. The earth's fertility, worshipped as the goddess.

Mars, god of war (red) = **Geburah**, symbol of severity, strength, power and judgement, matching the age of wars and the power of empires, and the development of the aggressive ego.

Jupiter, good fortune and guidance (blue) = **Chesed**, symbol of mercy and the flowing goodness and bounty of the divine power, worshipped in the church of traditional religion.

Saturn, limits and structure (brown) = **Daath**, symbol of hidden knowledge, shadow of the crown, and the shadow sides of life. This refers to the fact that esoteric knowledge was increasingly kept hidden while the limited, structuring knowledge of science developed during the Age of Kings. We are subject to our shadows while we still only have access to the Saturn level of limited structures and fate. Once we cross this "rainbow bridge," greater and freer awareness of the transcendent may be unveiled.

Uranus, individualism, invention, and revolution (orange) = **Binah**, the symbol of *form creation* in the Mind of God; rational archetypes, the left brain, technology, discovery, transcendental idealism. God's higher energies are becoming accessible to us in modern times as we reach these higher spheres above the abyss. The phase of liberation and the ideal of progress.

Neptune, mystical and socialist (lemon) = **Chokmah**, symbol of the creative flow of energy in the Mind of God, and the right brain, intuition, imagination, romanticism, collective consciousness. We contact this level of the Tree in mystical experience and compassion, which Neptune represents.

Pluto/Kuiper Belt, transformation, ecology (green) = **Kether**, symbol of the source and the crown, like the thousand-fold, diverse Kuiper Belt crowning our solar system, and the origin of the centaurs. The crown chakra is known as *sahasrara*, meaning thousand-fold. Pluto and the Kuiper Belt is diversity and ecology, and Kether is the unity of God and the One which brings all humanity together as One planet in the All-One-People meme of the Pluto era.

Chiron/Centaurs, the wounded healers = **the line descending to Tipareth**, like the centaurs pulled downward below Neptune and Pluto; the line connecting back down to the heart, the mythical "return" in the hero's journey, through healing and regression, leading to:

Sun, the soul and center from which life flows (yellow) = **Tipareth**, symbol of integration, balance, the heart, inclusiveness, competent leadership, becoming a radiant soul center, and "transcending" back up to:

Eris/Outer or Scattered Disc Objects (turquoise) = **Ain Soph Aur** and the other invisible sephiroth; holistic, leading out to the galaxy, the ethers, and Spirit the infinite Light.

We can see *Pluto/Kuiper Belt*, *Chiron/Centaurs*, and *Eris/Outer Objects*, much like Uranus/rahu, Neptune/ketu, and Pluto without the Belt, as *another trinity*, representing the crown, the current running down from the crown and above, and the current running up to the crown and beyond; a cosmic kundalini.

We can also associate these planetary phases with some of the [tarot](#) trump cards, particularly the worldly rulers:

- Mercury = The Magician
- Venus = The Empress and High Priestess
- Mars = The Emperor
- Jupiter = The Hierophant

We can also relate the *tarot cards* to the *paths* on the Tree of Life.

Tarot cards include the full sequence of these trump or major arcana cards from The Fool (card 0) to The World (card 22), representing the spiritual hero's journey. Occultists often place these 22 tarot trump cards on the "paths" of the Tree of Life, which are 22 lines connecting the circles (sephiroth), usually arranging them in sequence running from near the crown at Kether *down* to Malkuth at the bottom. I also propose in other articles and chapters that arranging them *from the bottom up* instead represents the path of the individual spiritual seeker. But remember in *this* article, using the Tree of Life symbol, we *reversed* the climb up the ladder of planets, from the Earth outward to Pluto and the

Kuiper Belt, changing it from the climb as it's related to the chakras within us (from Saturn up to the Sun). This represents our *collective* rather than our *individual* climb. Now that we are *completing* this collective climb up the Tree through the sephiroth, having reached Pluto at the top, where do we go from here? Perhaps if we are now moving downward again to *integrate* the stages on our climb, we have begun a new *collective spiritual quest*. This is emphasized by the fact that free spirituality is now pursued by vastly more people than ever before. This could be represented by the tarot cards placed on the paths in the traditional way, from the top downward. But as Pluto-Charon and the integral meme indicate, this means going *downward and upward* on "the path" *at the same time*, individual and collective at once.

If this is so, then in the 1960s and 70s we became **The Fool** (trump card #0 in the tarot series) and began our collective quest through the counter-cultural creative and new age movements, indeed seeming like fools as we started. But we *have* heard the new call together, and thus have begun the journey. It is now up to more of the people to recognize this. Since new technologies and holistic techniques came to us at Chiron's and Charon's discovery in 1977, we have become the **Magician** (trump #1), empowered by personal computers, smart phones, crystal wands and herbal remedies. If the new green movement reaches its climax in the 2040s, as I predict, that could indicate a **Priestess** stage (trump #2) in which our emerging feminine, esoteric and intuitive consciousness starts to fully blossom. Spiritual guides may appear then in greater abundance to help us move down the collective path to manifest God on Earth in a wiser way.

Even so, as we pursue a *collective* spiritual quest, each person's quest remains *personal*, and thus is represented by the climb *up the paths* of the Tree, from the bottom up, just as God emanates creative energy down the Tree to us through the circles from the crown. This is symbolized by the tarot cards beginning with the Fool and Magician placed on paths at the *bottom* of the Tree, and then moving up through the trump card sequence. See [The Tarot Journey](#) and [Bach Chakras Tarot](#) to follow this quest.

Principle American Ideologies, circa 2000-2020:

Mars/Red = militarism, imperialism (Republican Party)
Jupiter/Blue = religious right (Republican Party)
Saturn/Brown = scientism, materialism, secular humanism
(Democratic Party), or statist nationalism (Trump
Republican Party) Uranus/Orange = "free" market
economics (Republican Party, Libertarian Party)
Neptune/Lemon = social programs (Democratic Party)
Pluto/Green = greenpeace/diversity (Green Party,
post-60s Democratic Party)

We can accept that people are at different stages on the planetary or spiral dynamic, in America or in other cultures, and work with them on their level. We can also see how we might have "regressed," if we get stuck in unhealthy aspects of one of these memes that lie below the integral one, when we could, if made aware, release ourselves from their limitations and move up, transcending but still including the proper lessons from each meme in a higher synthesis.

We noted above that Mercury's place on the left side of the Tree of Life does not fit the description of the purple meme in Spiral Dynamics as group-oriented. Spiral Dynamics proposes that the stages alternate between assertiveness and bonding, but this is not entirely correct. Each stage also involves its *particular* way of bonding, generally in ever-larger groups:

Beige/Moon: extended families
Purple/Mercury: tribes
Pink/Venus: cities, towns, villages
Red/Mars: empires
Blue/Jupiter: church, religions
Brown/Saturn: dynastic states
Orange/Uranus: nations of free citizens, *la patrie*
Lemon/Neptune: economic class, workers collectives
Green/Pluto: all one people in one earth ecology
Yellow/Chiron and Sun: all the stages together in one integral whole
Turquoise/Eris: contact with the galaxy

What do *the asteroids* between Mars and Jupiter represent? Several interpretations are possible. They are often said to represent goddesses. The thousands of objects in the Asteroid Belt (which in total mass only amount to 4% of The Moon's) could represent the diversity of the

Hellenistic Age, late in the Mars stage, especially in the Roman Empire before Christianity became dominant in the Piscean Age ruled by Jupiter. This era was similar to our own, because people were mixing together and losing their separate tribal and imperial identities. Hermetic philosophy developed in this period because a great cross-fertilization of ideas could take place. But just as the asteroids "were too strongly perturbed by Jupiter's gravity to form a planet" [acc. to wikipedia](#), so the emerging power of the Jupiter meme under Christianity kept the many other cults and philosophies of the time from surviving or having much influence in the following era. The asteroids are a modern discovery, though; unknown in Hellenistic times. The largest asteroid Ceres, discovered in 1801, is now considered a dwarf planet and is larger than all the other asteroids put together. It represents the nourishing qualities of Nature, although some say it can be too fanatical. As we discovered the asteroids in the 19th century, we also discovered true history and also simultaneously the preoccupation with romanticizing the past, especially perhaps the times before Christianity became dominant under Jupiter in circa 300 AD. Pluto represents the similar diversity in our own time, just as Ceres and the asteroid belt did during the Hellenistic Era. Pluto brings us up into the Kuiper Belt, also full of thousands of objects representing another time of disintegration, *today*, which could lead us toward a New Age and beyond, as we move out beyond the solar system past Pluto and Eris into the galaxy and into spiritual dimensions too.

Planetary dynamics may have a *triple rhythm*, instead of alternating back and forth on a spiral. First, mobile and very spiritual or romantic (tribal Mercury, religious Jupiter, romantic Neptune), then settled and land-based (agricultural Venus, royal Saturn, green Pluto/plutinos), and finally competitive and synthetic (warrior/classical Mars, revolutionary/idealist Uranus, integral centaurs and Sun).

Why should planets and other objects in the solar system have such significance here on Earth? I have discussed this elsewhere in my [Horoscope for the New Millennium](#) book. Some further notes: although we can calculate the motions of celestial bodies by using "physical laws," these laws always have an element of uncertainty, according to modern physics. Just like organic objects and minerals on Earth, the objects in space should not be confused with tools that we create by applying these mechanical laws. These objects are embedded in the whole system, and thus are organic in a similar way. Our bodies have evolved from this larger whole, and our consciousness has emerged through it, since as has been said, "we are stardust." There is more up there, as well as down here, than meets the eye or the mechanical mind. The hermetic law "as above, so below" is now widely recognized in its modern form as holography and fractile mathematics. In this article I am not discussing astrological *influences* per se, but rather that we can find in our greater cosmos, and in ancient philosophy, powerful *models, symbols and maps* (e.g. planetary symbols, the chakras, the Tree of Life) that illuminate the various stages of our journey through life. They represent the living, radiant and colorful aspects of ourselves within the greater whole, according to the maxims, *as above, so below*, and *as within, so without*. And they all have their place on *the philosophers wheel*.